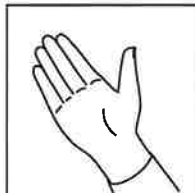


BASIC HANDSHAPES

Closed Hand



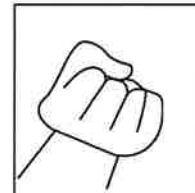
Flat Hand



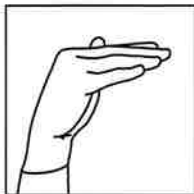
Clawed Hand



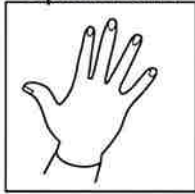
Fist



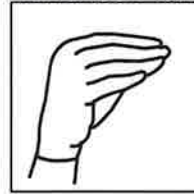
Bent Hand



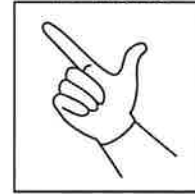
Open Hand



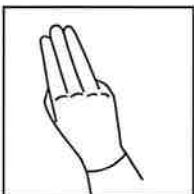
Bunched Hand



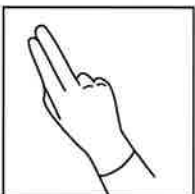
'L' Hand



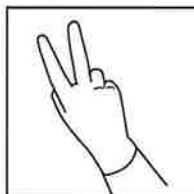
'M' Hand



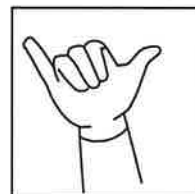
'N' Hand



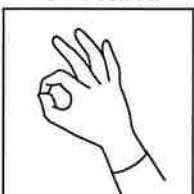
'V' Hand



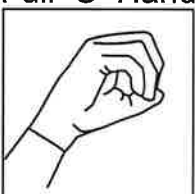
'Y' Hand



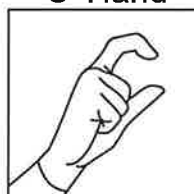
'O' Hand



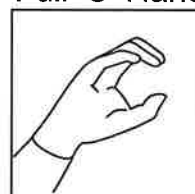
Full 'O' Hand



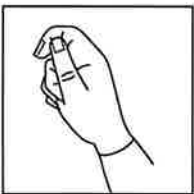
'C' Hand



Full 'C' Hand



Irish 'T' Hand



Frequently used handshapes in BSL and terms used in this book to describe them.

The fingers are identified (from the thumb) as ***index, middle finger, ring finger*** and ***little finger***.

THE DRAWINGS: The Face

The drawings show the important components of the signs as clearly as possible without distracting background details. One of the most important of these components is the face.

Learners typically focus on the hands and movement of the signs and tend to neglect the importance of the face, at least in the early stages. Communication in BSL however starts with eye contact, and the face is the focal point throughout.

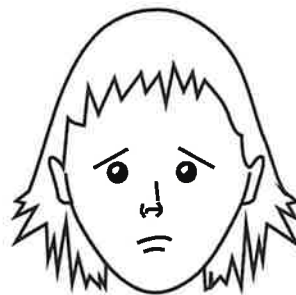
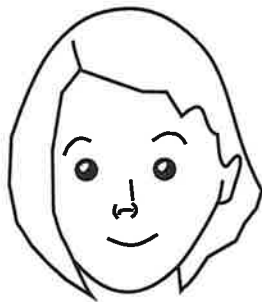
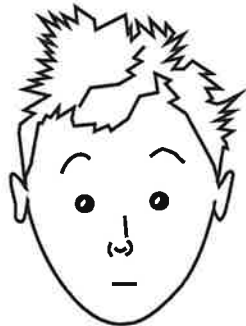
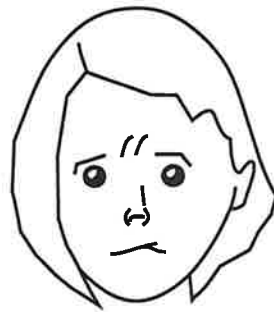
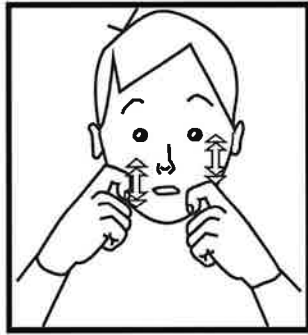
Signing can be dull or even meaningless without good and appropriate facial clues or if part of the face is obscured by dark glasses, beard, or moustache for example.

The facial expressions in the drawings are appropriate to some signs in some contexts, but not all the possibilities can be shown. BSL uses a range of eye, mouth and facial movements that have grammatical functions in that they can add to, modify or change meaning.

These are termed ***non-manual features*** (as in the sign at the top left of the next page) and they are referred to and described in the captions where space permits.

Some excellent photographic examples and details of BSL grammar can be found in the books detailed in Recommended Resources and Reading.

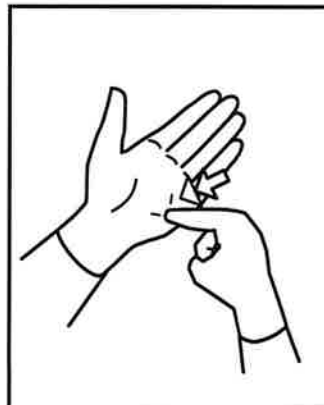
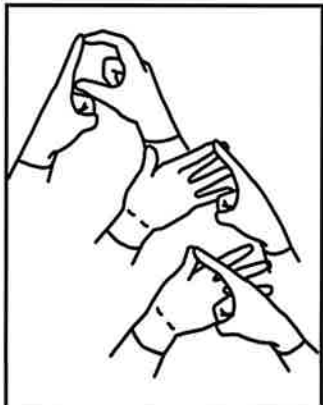
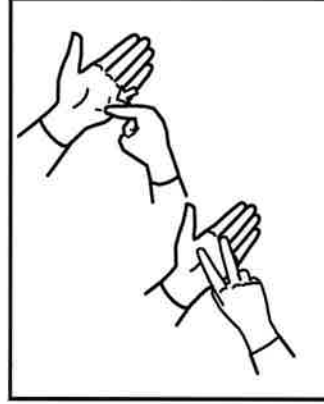
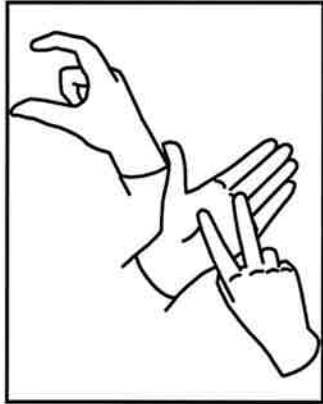
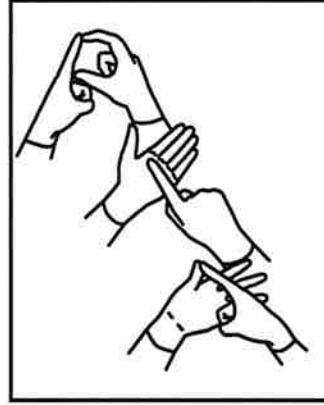
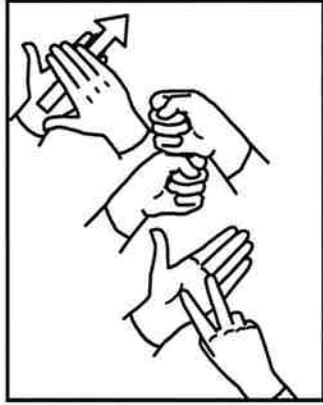
NON-MANUAL FEATURES: The Face



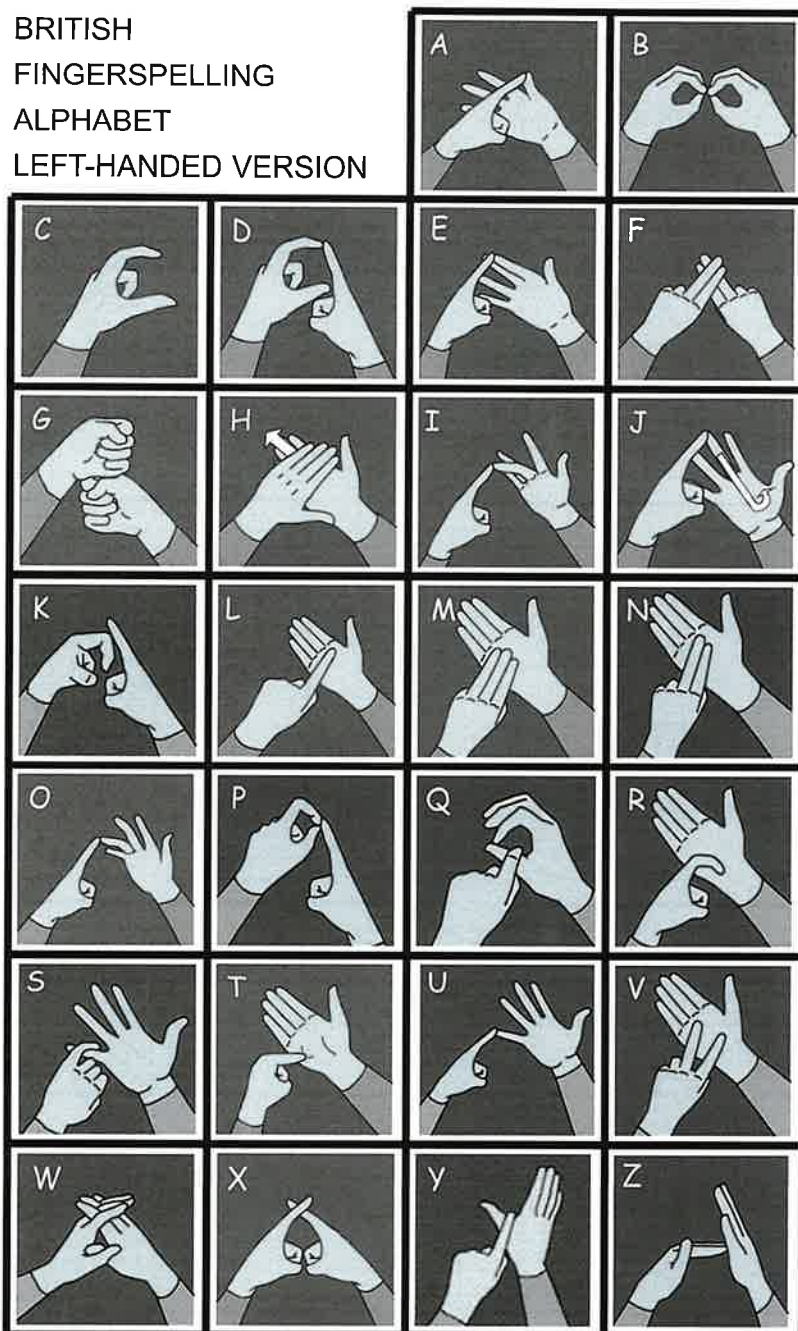
ABOUT FINGERSPELLING

Fingerspelling is a manual representation of the letters of the alphabet. Drawings give a static image of the alphabet, but in fluent use, the shapes can merge and appear quite different. They are recognised as word patterns, and this requires practice.

- Fingerspelling is an important and integral part of BSL but relies on the understanding of English and should be used with caution.
- Its use varies considerably between individuals.
- It is rarely used to spell out whole phrases or sentences.
- It is commonly used for names and places.
- It is used for acronyms eg **BSL**, **GCSE**, **NVQ**, **ATW (Access to Work)** - see examples **HGV**, **CV**, **DEA**, **DLA** opposite.
- Words can be spelt out in full, abbreviated or initialised - see examples **TV** and **TT (toilet)** opposite.
- Days of the week and months of the year can also be signed with a repeated initial or abbreviated pattern, e.g. **Wednesday** - **WW**, **January** - **JAN**, and so on.

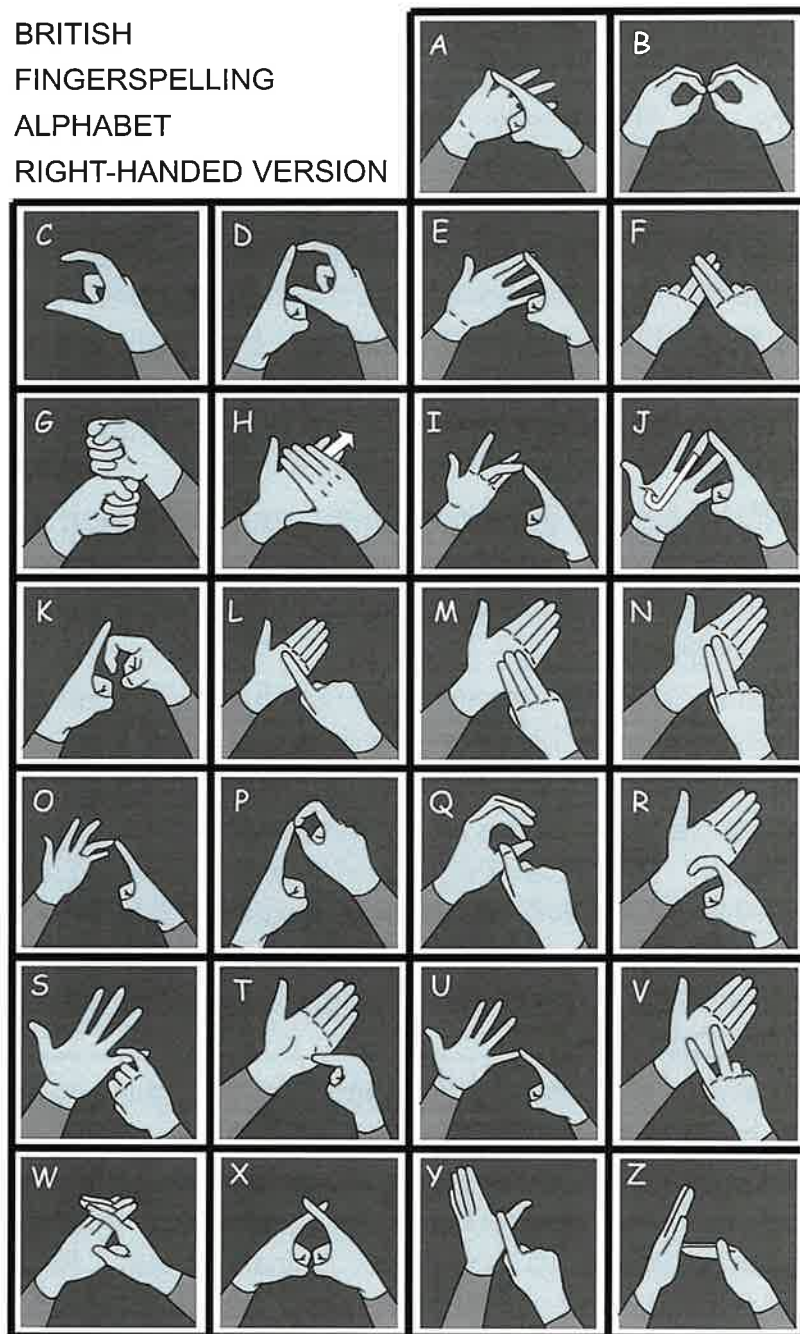


BRITISH
FINGERSPELLING
ALPHABET
LEFT-HANDED VERSION



© 2007 DEAFSIGN www.deafsign.com From the LET'S SIGN SERIES, may be copied as reminder sheet.

BRITISH
FINGERSPELLING
ALPHABET
RIGHT-HANDED VERSION



© 2007 DEAFSIGN www.deafsign.com From the LET'S SIGN SERIES, may be copied as reminder sheet.

FINGERSPELLING: Days of the Week

Days of the week are commonly based on fingerspelling. These are usually abbreviated forms as shown in the illustrations opposite.

In addition to the example of MONDAY represented by 'MON', a repeated 'MM' is also alternatively used. TUESDAY may be represented by 'TU' 'TT', or 'TUES', WEDNESDAY by 'WED' or 'WW', THURSDAY by 'TH', and FRIDAY by 'FRI' or 'FF', and other similar variations.

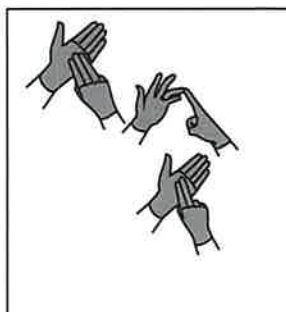
SUNDAY can be signed as in the last illustration with the flat hands tapping together twice, although SATURDAY and SUNDAY do have alternative signs in some regions.

Months of the year are similarly fingerspelt abbreviations or the shorter words are spelt in full, eg MAY, JUNE.

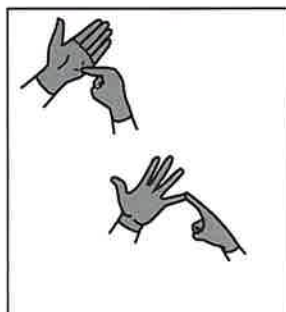
A separate 'days of the week' system is mainly used in Scotland. The index finger and thumb close together twice for MONDAY, the middle finger and thumb for TUESDAY, the ring finger and thumb for WEDNESDAY and little finger and thumb for THURSDAY.

FRIDAY is signed with R. palm left 'V' hand moving right to left across the chin. SATURDAY is a repeated downward opening movement of a closed hand held under the chin, and SUNDAY is palm left R. flat hand bending back to contact upper chest twice. SATURDAY and SUNDAY also have alternative versions in some regions.

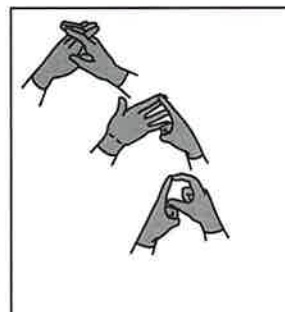
DAYS OF THE WEEK



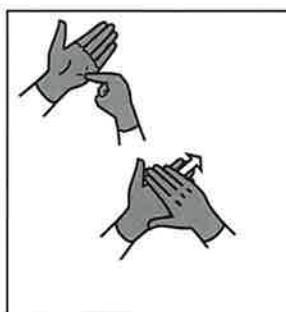
MONDAY



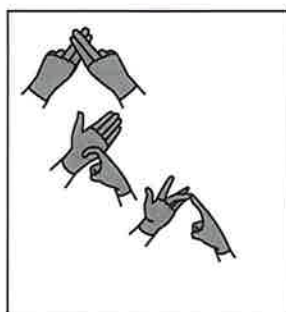
TUESDAY



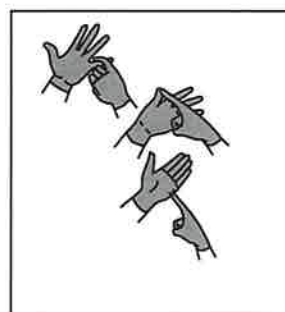
WEDNESDAY



THURSDAY

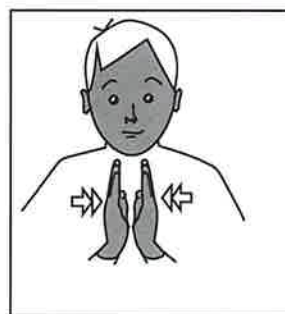


FRIDAY



SATURDAY

There are other variations for signing days of the week, but these are commonly used and understood examples used in BSL.



SUNDAY

NUMBERS: Quick Reference Guide

Numbers are notorious for their regional variations. It is not possible to show them all in this simple guide, but the two most commonly used and understood systems are illustrated. Learners need to be aware of their own regional versions and variations used in other areas.



© 2007 DEAFSIGN www.deafsign.com From the LET'S SIGN SERIES, may be copied as reminder sheet.

20 is illustrated - 30, 40, 50, 60 etc start with the relevant number handshape for 3, 4, 5, (6 and so on from either system) followed by zero, up to 90.



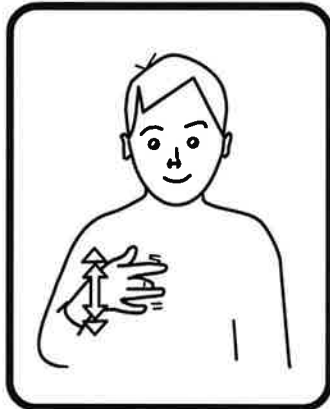
© 2007 DEAFSIGN www.deafsign.com From the LET'S SIGN SERIES, may be copied as reminder sheet.





ACCESS, GO THROUGH

R. flat hand moves forward/left between fingers of L. hand. With sharp movement, also means **BUTT IN, INTERRUPT**.
Directional.



ADDRESS, LIVE

Tip of middle finger (or clawed hand) rubs up and down on side of chest. Also ***regional*** sign for **TOILET**.



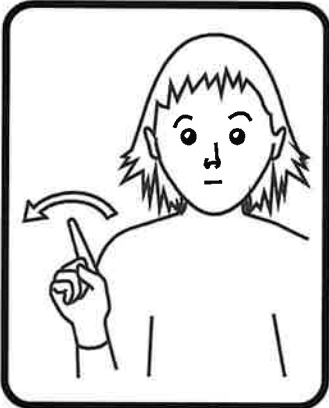
ADVICE, ADVISE/R

R. index moves from mouth then changes to a closed hand with thumb up on L. palm and hands move forward together.



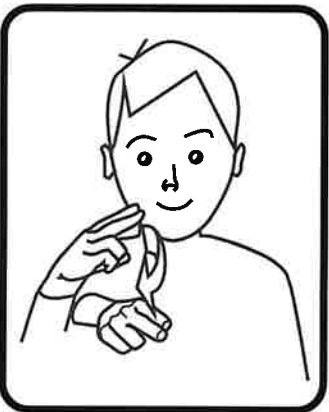
AFTER, AFTERWARDS

Palm down R. closed hand with thumb out moves over L. in small arc. Flat hand can be used. Also means **THEN**. *Varies*.



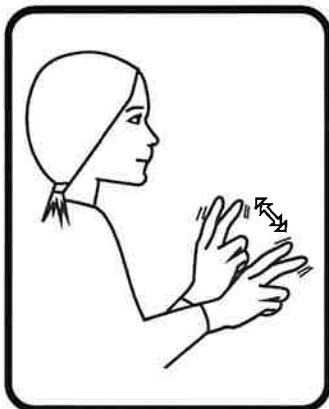
AFTER, LATER

Palm forward index finger moves sideways in small arc. Movement may repeat. *Varies*.



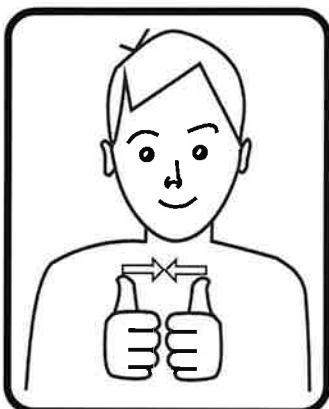
AFTERNOON

Tips of 'N' hand touch chin, then hand twists from wrist to point forwards.



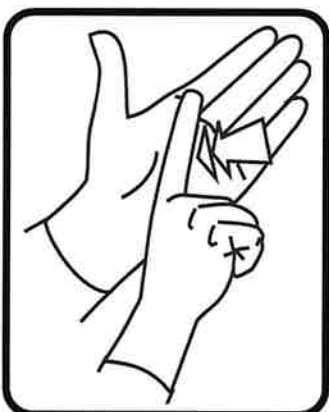
AGAIN, REPEAT

Palm left 'V' hand makes short quick shaking movements forward/down from the wrist. Also means **FREQUENTLY, OFTEN.**



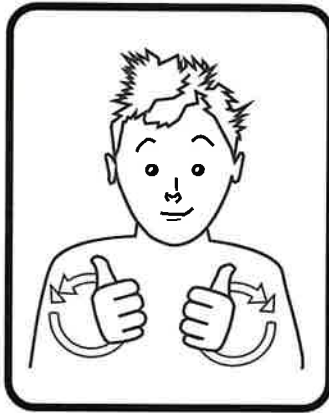
AGREE, AGREEMENT

Closed hands with thumbs up contact knuckles together. The head nods, lips pressed together. Also means **APPROPRIATE, SUIT/ABLE.**



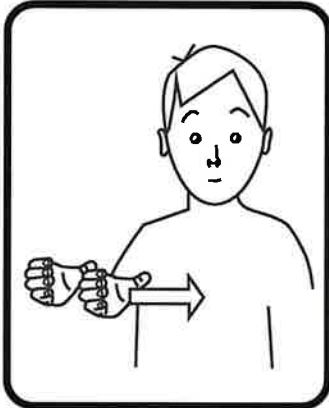
ALARM, BELL (clock, fire)

Side of extended R. index finger bangs twice against the L. palm. Index waggles forward/down for **CLOCK.** See also **FIRE.**



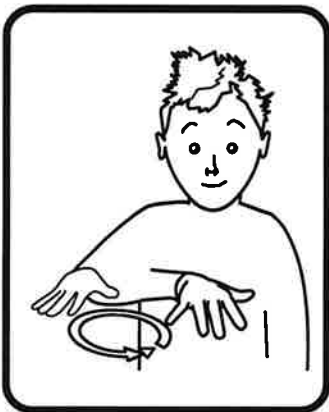
ALRIGHT, FINE, OK

Closed hands with thumbs up and pointing slightly out move in outward circles. Eyebrows raised for '*are you ok?*' etc.



APPOINT, EMPLOY

Full 'C' hand moves inwards from the side. Also means **SUBSTITUTE, SUPPLY.**



AREA, LOCAL, PLACE

Palm down open hand makes horizontal circular movements. Also means **REGION.**



ARRIVE, REACH, GET TO

R. bent hand moves in forward arc to contact L. palm held forward.



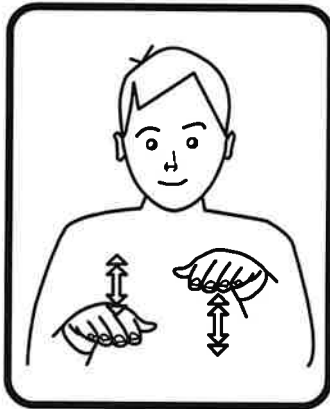
ASK, APPLY, REMIND

Palm forward bent hand makes two short forward movements (***directional***). Also means **PESTER** (firm movements).



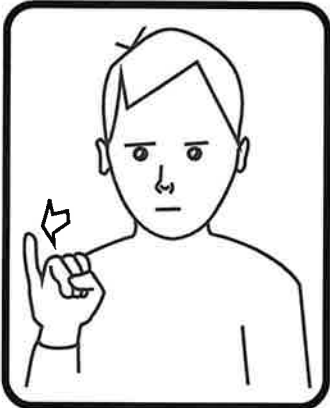
ASK, REQUEST

R. 'O' hand near side of mouth, moves forward in small arc. ***Directional***.



ASSESS/MENT

Hands move alternately up and down several times, palm up or palm down. 'N' hands can also be used.



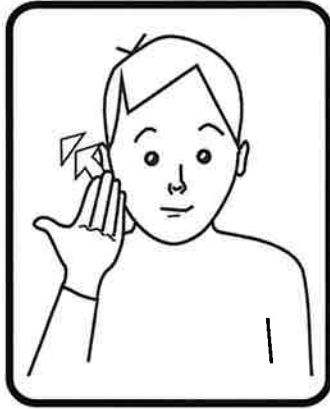
BAD, WRONG

Extended little finger makes short movement forward. May repeat.



BEFORE, EARLIER, EARLY

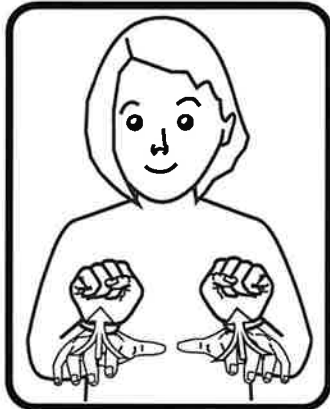
R. flat hand moves from wrist up left forearm in small arc. ***Varies.***



BEFORE, PAST, PREVIOUS

R. flat hand moves backwards over right shoulder several times.

Refers to **IN THE PAST**, as in '*I worked there before*'.



BEGIN, START

Open hands palm down/back snap closed as hands twist to palm forward. ***Varies.***



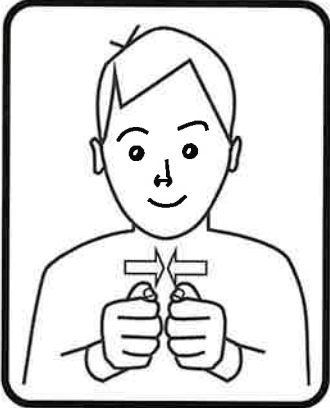
BEST

Tip of R. extended thumb brushes forward sharply against top of L. extended thumb.



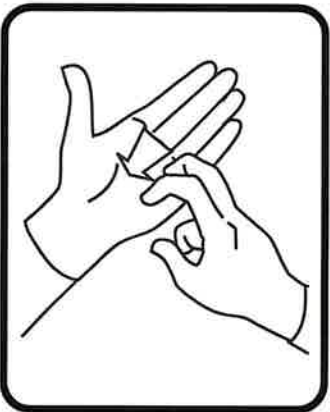
BISCUIT

Tips of R. clawed hand tap twice against left elbow.
May *vary*.



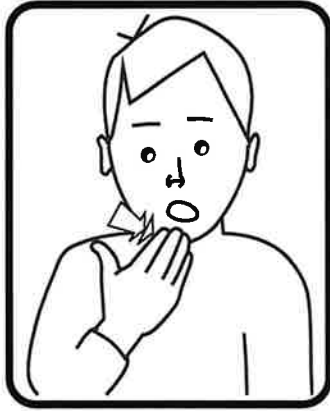
BOOK (to), APPOINTMENT

Closed hands come together to contact at the knuckles.



BOOK (to), CONTRACT

Tips of bent R. 'V' hand contact L. palm.
Also means **RESERVE** or **MAKE A BOOKING** eg of an interpreter.



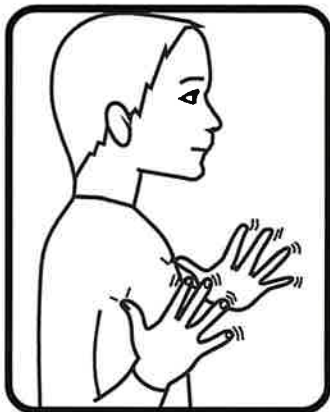
BORE/D, BORING, YAWN

Flat hand taps chin several times with mouth slightly open as if stifling a yawn.



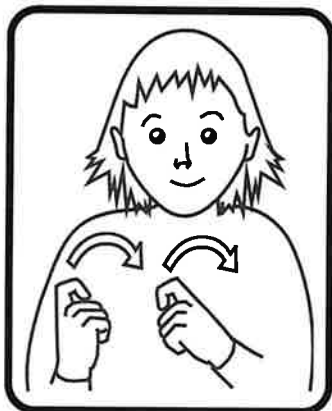
BOSS/Y, MANAGER, HEAD

Index fingers pointing forward/up twist sharply up/back from wrist. May be one hand only. Also means **AUTHORITY, EMPLOYER, CHIEF.**



BREAK, LEISURE, REST

Thumb tips of open hands (or one hand) on chest, fingers may wiggle. Head may tilt. Also means **RELAX.**



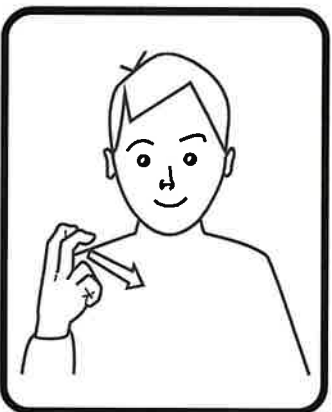
BRING, FETCH

Irish 'T' hands move simultaneously from right to left in small arc, or in **direction** to suit context.



BUS, LORRY, TRUCK, VAN

Palm up closed hands make wide flat steering movements. Also means **DRIVE, DRIVER**.



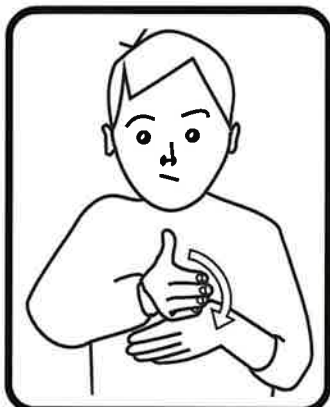
BUS, TUBE, UNDERGROUND

Fingers of bent 'V' hand make short movement forward at shoulder height (**regional**).



BUSINESS

Little finger edge of palm up flat hand taps into side of body twice.



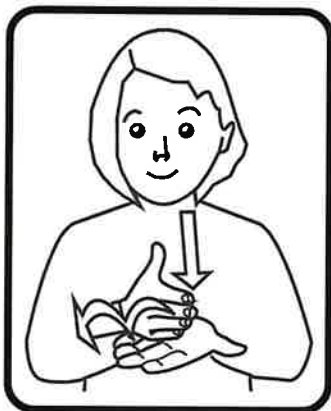
BUSY, HARD WORK

R. flat hand swivels forward/down over back of L. Cheeks may be puffed.



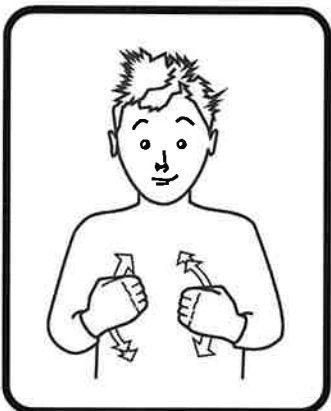
BYE, GOODBYE, CHEERIO

Hand moves side to side in waving movement, or flat hand bends repeatedly from palm knuckle.



CAR PARK

Edge of R. flat hand (vehicle classifier) contacts L. palm several times with small movements to the right, like cars in a row.



CAR, DRIVE, DRIVER

Closed hands move in action of holding and moving a steering wheel.

DRIVE may be short forward movement of both hands.



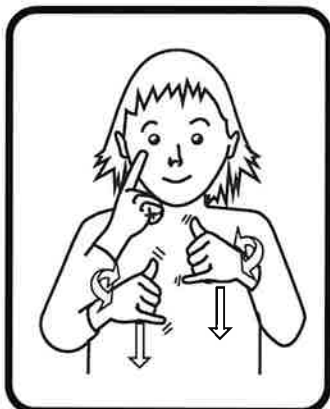
CERTIFICATE

'O' hands held apart, one higher than the other, make small repeated shaking movements. Also means **QUALIFICATION**.



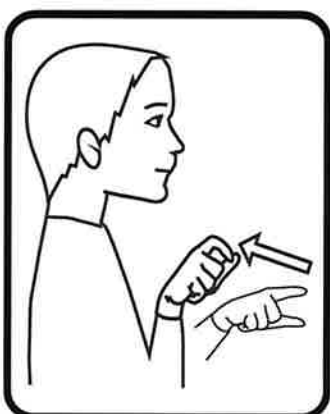
CHANGE, ALTER, CONVERT

Irish 'T' hands (or upright index fingers) held palms facing twist round each other to finish crossed over. ***Varies.***



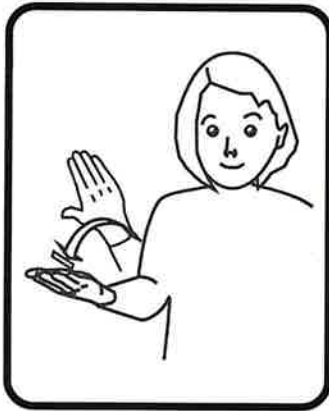
CHECK, TEST, TRY OUT

Index moves down from eye, then 'Y' hands (or just one hand) move down in waggling movements from wrists. ***Directional.***



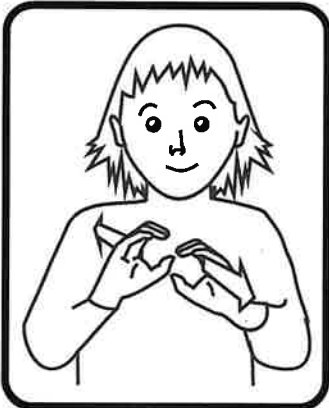
CHOOSE, PICK, SELECT

Index finger closes onto thumb as hand moves backwards. May repeat, and with two hands alternately. ***Directional.*** Also means **INVITE.**



CLAIM

Flat hand moves sharply down/forward to finish palm up.



COACH, BUS

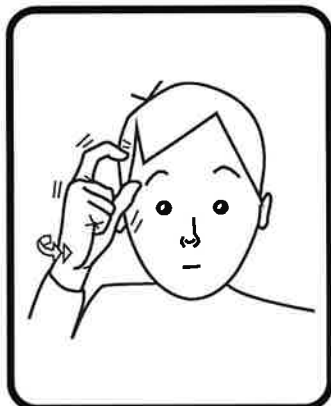
Full 'C' hands, one in front of the other, pull diagonally apart, forward/back.



COFFEE

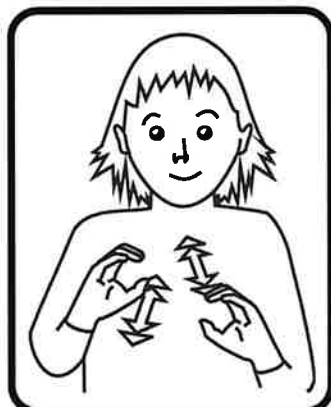
'C' hand makes short quick twisting movements near side of mouth or R. fist grinds on top of L.

Varies.



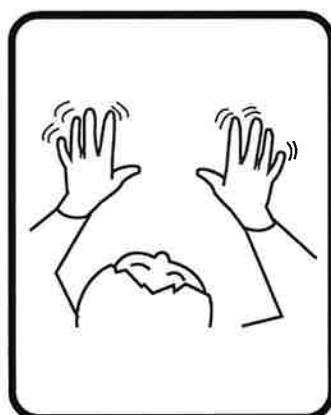
COLLEGE

'C' hand makes short quick twisting movements from the wrist near the side of forehead. ***Varies.***



COMMUNICATE

Full 'C' hands (or 'C' hands) move backwards and forwards alternately. Also means **COMMUNICATION, COMMUNICATOR.**



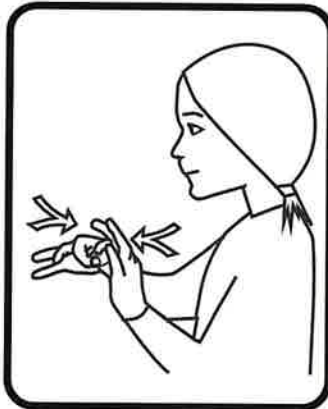
COMPUTER, KEYBOARD

Fingers of palm down hands wiggle. Also means **TYPE.** May be combined sign for **SCREEN.**



CONFIDENTIAL

Clawed hands move inwards, one in front of the other in front of the mouth closing sharply to fists.



CONTACT, LINK, JOIN

Hands move towards each other and fingers of 'O' hands interlock.

Directional. Also means **CONNECT, CONNECTION.**



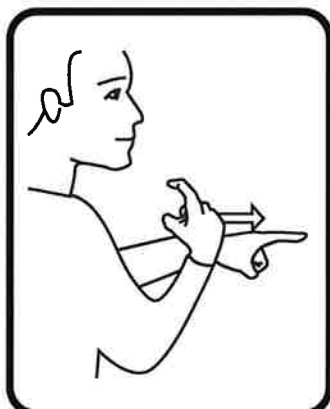
CONTINUE, CARRY ON

Palm down 'C' hands (or just one hand) move simultaneously to the right, or forwards. Also means **PERMANENT.**



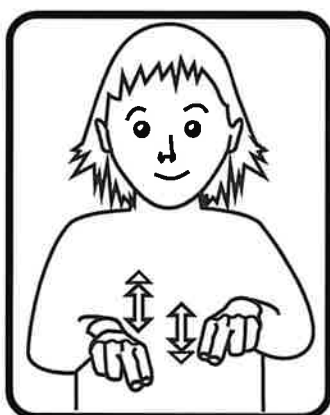
CORRIDOR, HALL

'N' hands move forward at sides of head. Flat hands can be used. Also means **PASSAGE**.



COURSE, SCHEME

Edge of R 'C' hand moves forward along L. hand.



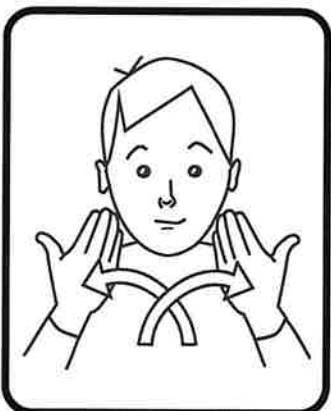
COURT, TRIAL, TRIBUNAL

'N' hands move alternately up and down. Can be palm up or palm down or use flat hands. Also means **ASSESS/MENT**.



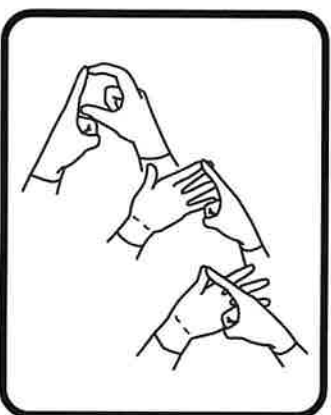
DANGER, DANGEROUS

Edge of R. flat hand comes up sharply to forehead. May tap twice on forehead.



DAY, DAWN, LIGHT

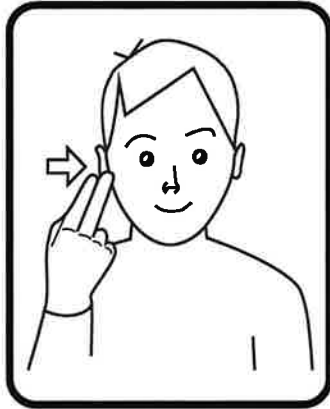
Palm back open hands start crossed and swing upwards and apart. **DAY** is often also fingerspelt.



DEA

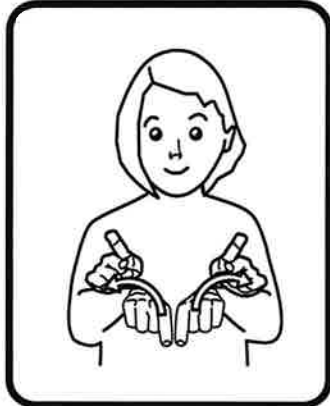
DISABILITY EMPLOYMENT ADVISER

Sign the three signs, or fingerspell 'DEA'.



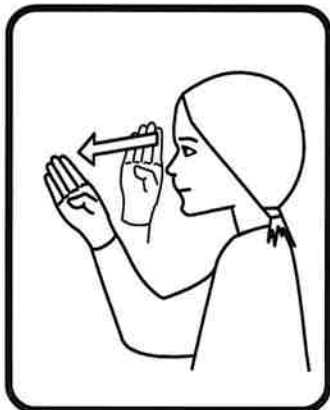
DEAF, DEAF PERSON

'N' hand contacts ear.
Cheeks may be puffed for
**PROFOUNDLY DEAF, REALLY
DEAF.**



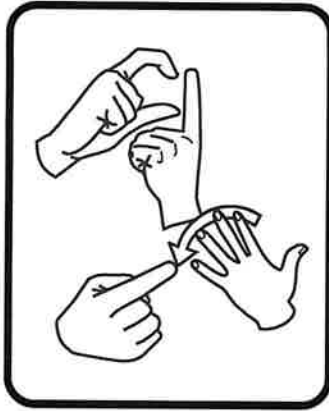
DIFFERENT, DIFFERENCE

Index fingers held together
twist over and apart.



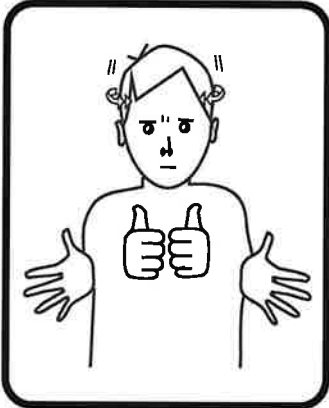
DIRECT, STRAIGHT

Flat hand bends forward
from the wrist as it moves
forward from in front of
nose. Also means
STRAIGHT ON.



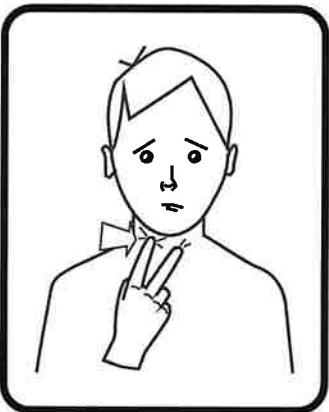
DISABILITY, DISABLED

Hands form fingerspelt 'D' then R. index brushes down along the tips of L. fingers.



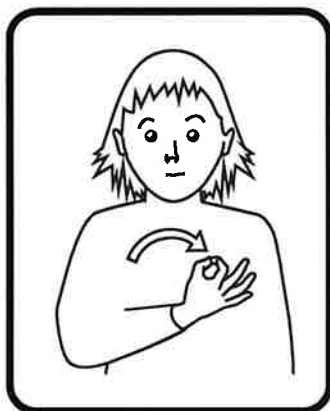
DISAGREE, DON'T AGREE

Closed hands with thumbs up touch at knuckles, then spring open and apart as the head shakes.



DISAPPOINT/MENT

Tips of 'V' hand prod neck, may repeat. Lips pressed together and turned down. Also **FRUSTRATED, MISS** (*regional*).



DOCTOR, MEDICAL

Tips of 'O' hand contact right, then left sides of chest. ***Varies.***



DON'T KNOW

Flat hand swings down to palm up from forehead as shoulders shrug, head shakes, lips pressed together.



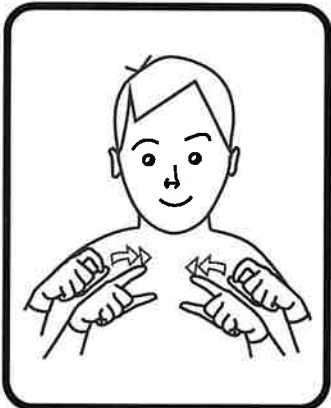
DON'T LIKE, DISLIKE

Open hand on chest twists forwards/up as head shakes with negative expression. May move palm down away from body.



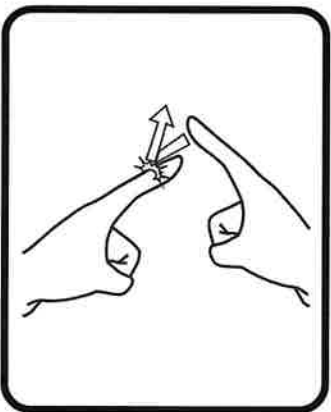
DON'T WANT, DON'T NEED

Flat hand moves firmly down and away from body as head shakes.



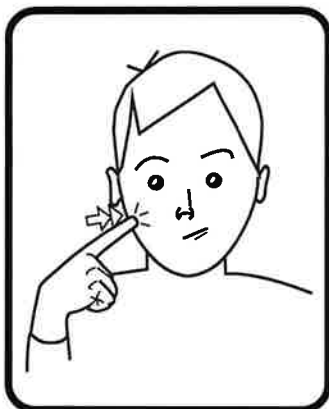
E-MAIL

Index fingers flick off thumbs towards each other. Can be one hand only. ***Directional.***



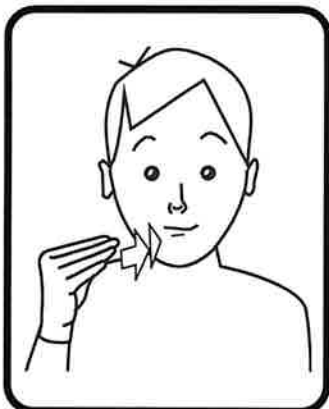
EARLY, EMERGENCY

R. index bangs sharply on L. index and bounces up again. Also means **QUICK, SUDDEN, URGENT.**



EASY, SIMPLE, SOFT

Index finger prods into the cheek twice. The cheeks may be puffed.



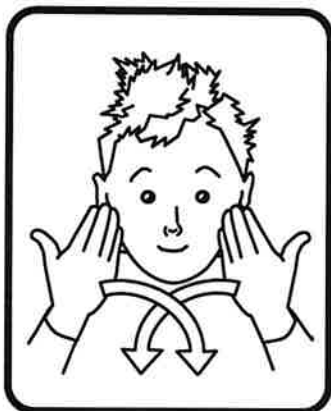
EAT, FOOD

Bunched hand makes two short movements to the mouth. Also means **LUNCH, SUPPER.**



EMPLOYER, MANAGER

Thumbs of 'Y' hands jab into sides of upper chest. Also means **BOSS, CHIEF, OWNER** etc. One of several variations.



EVENING, NIGHT

Palm back flat hands swing in/down to finish crossed. ***Varies.***



EXPERIENCE

Thumb tip touches forehead then moves down as flat hand with fingertips brushing past L. palm. Also means **KNOW ABOUT**. ***Varies.***



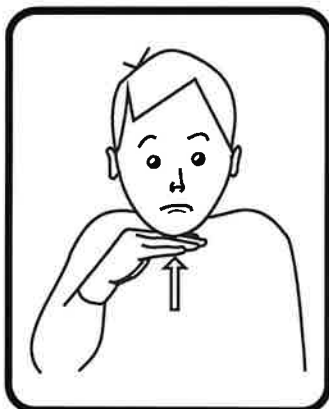
EXPLAIN, TELL ABOUT

Flat hands rotate round each other in forward circles eg 'I'll explain' or backwards eg 'explain to me'. ***Directional.***



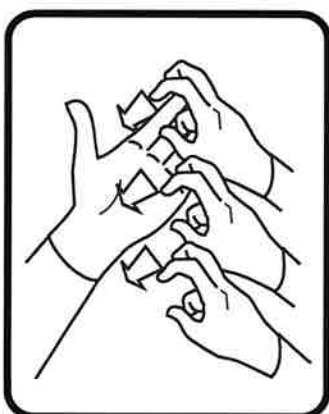
FAX, SEND A FAX

R. flat hand moves down/forward in small arc under L. or twists round and moves back to signer (*directional*).



FED UP, SICK OF, ENOUGH

Bent hand bangs up against underside of chin. May repeat. Shoulders and corners of mouth droop.



FILL IN FORM, NOTES

Tips of bent 'V' hand (or 'N' hand) make short movements towards L. palm several times, moving down.



FINGERSPELL, SPELL

Fingers and thumbs wiggle against each other as hands move to the right. Refers to two handed fingerspelling.



FINISH, END, STOP

Fingers of bent hands close onto thumbs in short firm downward movement.



FINISH/ED, COMPLETED

Closed hands with thumbs up and pointing slightly out move in outward circles.

Regional.



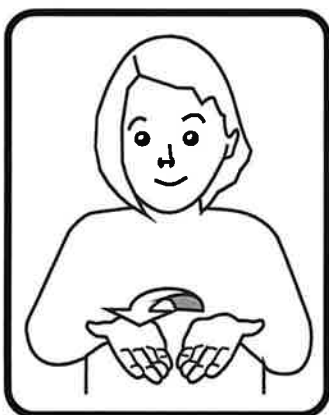
FIRE ESCAPE

Palm facing hands move up, fingers wiggling (**FIRE**), then R. extended index moves sharply forward under palm down L. hand.



FIRE, BURN, FLAMES

Fingers of palm facing open hands wiggle as hands move up and down alternately. May ***vary in context.***



GIVE, OFFER, LET

Palm up hands (or just one) move in forward arc or in ***direction*** to suit context. Also means **GIFT, PRESENT.**



GO, GONE, WENT, SENT

Index finger swings forward/up from wrist to point forward. ***Varies.***



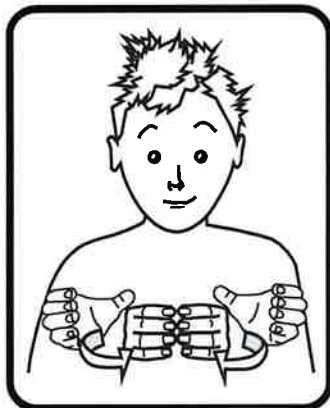
GOING TO, INTEND

Back of extended thumb taps side of upper chest twice. Lips are stretched. Also means **ANTICIPATE, EXPECT.**



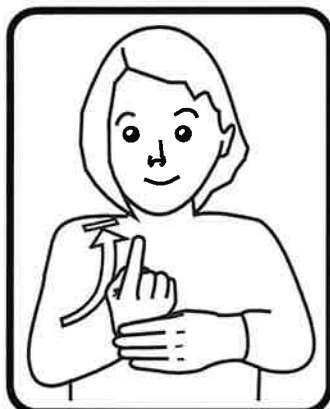
GOOD, GREAT, HELLO

Closed hand (or both hands) with thumb up makes short movement forward.



GROUP, TEAM

Full 'C' hands move in twisting at the wrists to touch together at fingertips. ***Varies.***



HAPPEN, ARISE, CROP UP

R. index moves sharply up behind L. hand, or makes upward flicking movement in front of L. hand.



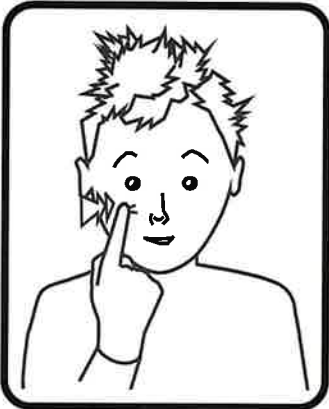
HAPPY, ENJOY, GLAD

Hands make repeated contact brushing against each other, with pleased expression.



HARD, DIFFICULT/Y

Tip of R. thumb prods into L. palm twice, eyebrows furrowed.



HAVE A LOOK, LET'S SEE

Tip of index finger taps cheek just below eye twice. Also means **CHECK OUT**.



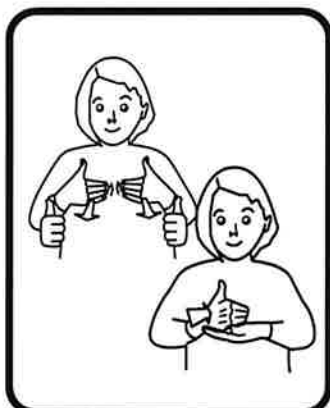
HAVE TO, COMPULSORY

Flat hands held apart make short firm downward movement with stress. Also means **MUST**.



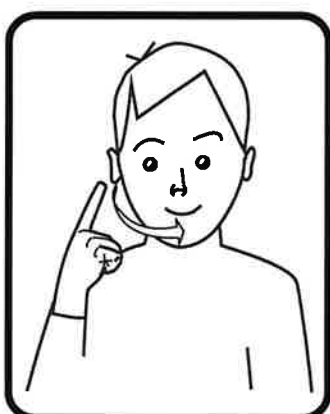
HAVE, GET, POSSESS/ION

Palm up clawed hand makes slight downward movement as it closes firmly.



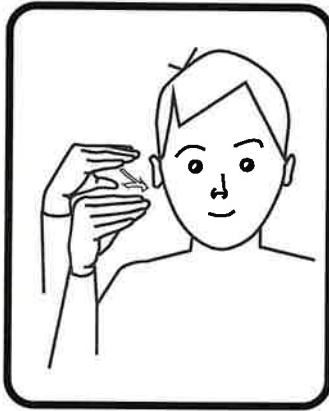
HEALTH AND SAFETY

Tips of flat hands touch chest, and move forward, thumbs up, then edge of R. bent hand on L. palm as hands move back.



HEARING (not deaf)

Index finger moves from ear to mouth. May finish with repeated tap on chin.



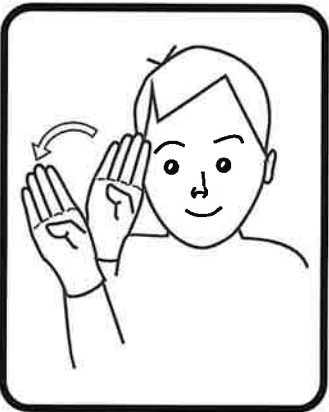
HEARING LOSS, DEAFENED

Fingers close onto thumb near ear with downward movement. Also means **LOSE HEARING, BECOME DEAF**. Or fingerspell 'HOH' for **HARD OF HEARING**.



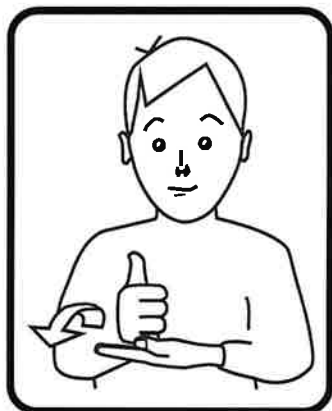
HELLO

Closed hands with thumbs up twist sharply over from palm down to palms facing.



HELLO, HI

Flat hand with thumb tucked in makes short movement out from near side of head. **Varies**.



HELP/ER, ASSISTANT

Closed hand with thumb up rests on L. palm as both hands move forward.

Directional. Also means **SUPPORT.**



HGV

Fingerspell 'HGV'.



HOLIDAY

Flat hands move from sides of head, twisting to palm forward, slightly down and apart. ***Varies.***



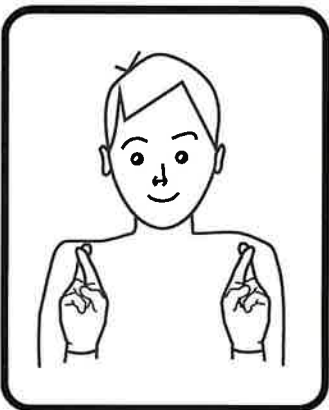
HOLIDAY, CELEBRATION

Irish 'T' hands make circling movements near sides of head, or same movement with extended middle fingers (*regional*).



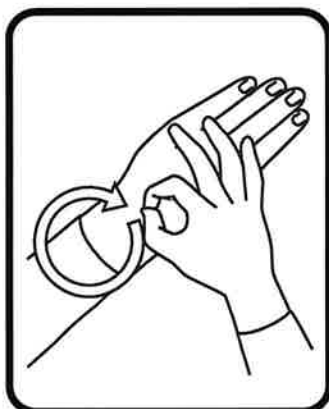
HOME

Tips of flat hands touch, with hands held at an angle.



HOPE, HOPEFULLY, WISH

Fingers are held crossed, palm forward. May be one hand only. *Varies*.



HOUR

R. 'O' hand moves round in circle over left wrist or palm, or R. extended index twists round in full circle. ***Varies.***



HOW ARE YOU?

Tips of bent hands on chest; hands move forward closing with thumbs up, eyebrows raised. Also means **ARE YOU WELL?**



HOW OLD? WHAT AGE?

Fingers wiggle in front of nose. Eyebrows are raised or furrowed.



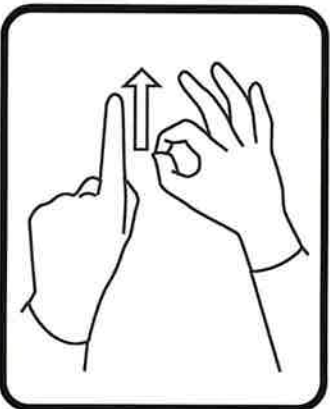
ILL, ILLNESS, NOT WELL

Little fingers (or just one) brush down chest, head may tilt, may repeat. Also a **regional** sign for **TIRED**.



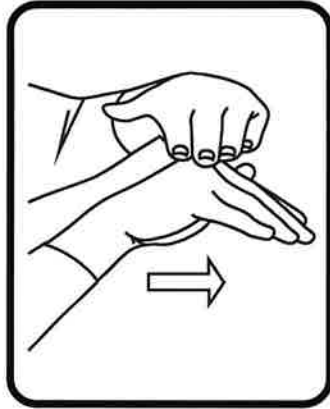
IMPORTANT, CRUCIAL

R. open hand comes down to land on tip of L. index. May tap twice. Also means **TOP**.



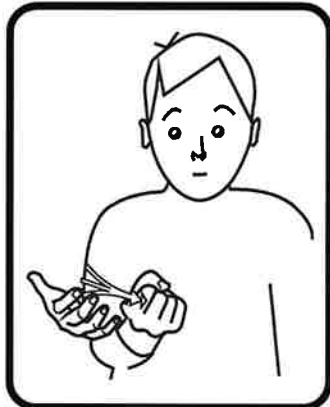
IMPROVE, IMPROVEMENT

Tips of R. 'O' hand move upwards on upright L. index finger. Also means **GET BETTER**.



IN, GO IN, ENTER, ENTRY

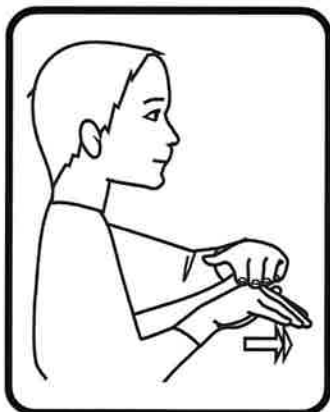
R. bent hand straightens to a flat hand as it moves forward under L. hand.



INCOME, EARNINGS

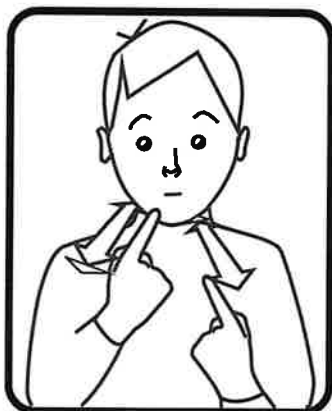
Palm up clawed hand moves in/down to body twice, closing to a fist.

Also means **BENEFIT, DOLE, PENSION, WAGES** and other forms of income.



INDOORS, INSIDE

R. bent hand makes two short movements under L. hand.



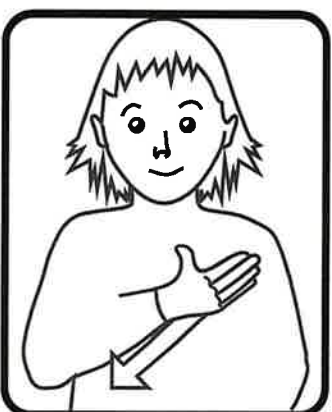
INFORM, INFORMATION

Palm back extended index fingers move quickly forwards and backwards from the mouth.



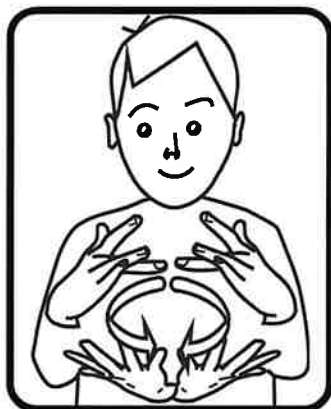
INJURY, HURT

Palm back open hands shake up and down from the wrists alternately in front of the body with pained expression.



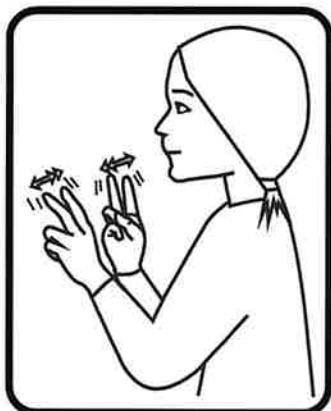
INSURE, INSURANCE

Edge of R. bent hand moves diagonally down across the chest.



INTERNET, NET, WEB

Tips of middle fingers touch briefly, then hands move out and round in sphere shape.



INTERPRET/ER

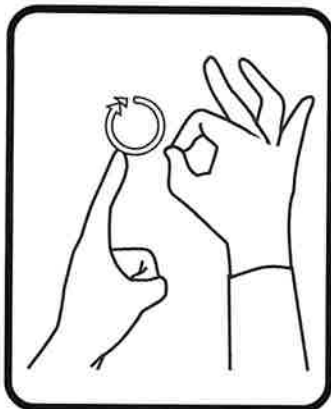
'V' hands (or 'N' hands) twist alternately backwards and forwards from the wrists.



INTERVIEW, CONVERSE

Palm facing index fingers move forward and back to the mouth alternately.

Also means **DIALOGUE**, **DISCUSS**.



INTERVIEW, ENQUIRY

Tips of R. 'O' hand makes repeated contact with L. index in circular movements.



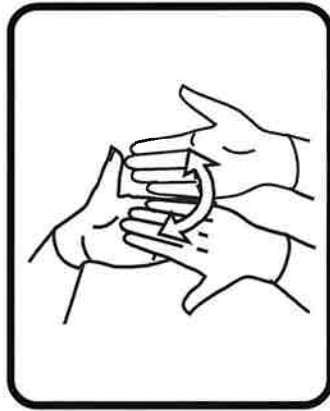
JOIN, ATTACH, LINK

Hands move towards each other and fingers of 'O' hands interlock.



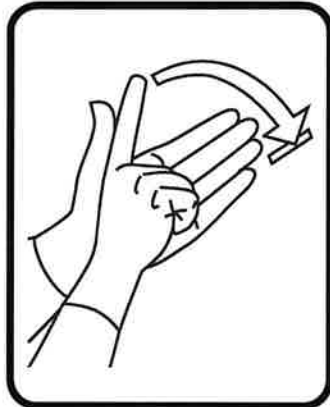
KNOW

Thumb tip taps on side of forehead.



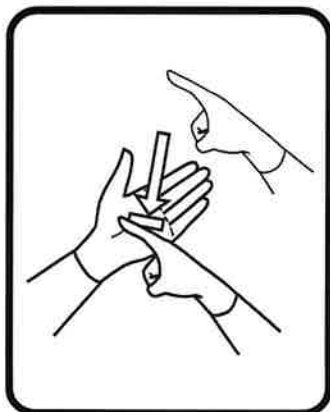
LAPTOP COMPUTER

Palm back flat hands, R. on top of L. twists over to contact L. palm, then back again.



LATE, OVERDUE

R. extended index twists sharply forward/down across L. palm.



LAW, RULE, PRINCIPLE

Edge of R. index finger lands sharply on L. palm.



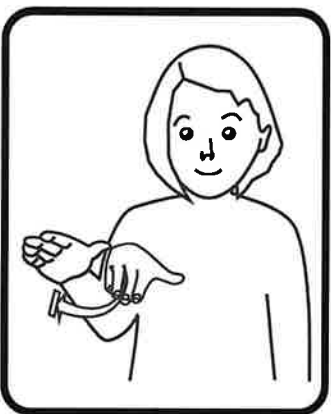
LAZY, IDLE

R. bent hand taps left elbow twice, tip of tongue between teeth. Also one version of **BISCUIT**.



LEARN, ACQUIRE, TAKE IN

Palm forward hand (or both hands) twists back to side of head, closing to a bunched hand. **Varies.**



LEAVE, GO, DEPART

Palm back flat hand swings forward/right from wrist to finish palm down.



LET ME KNOW

Bent hand with thumb out moves down from forehead to contact body closing to a bunched hand.



LET YOU KNOW

Bent hand with thumb out moves down from forehead and forward or in ***direction*** of person referred to, closing to a bunched hand.



LETTER, MAIL, STAMP

Tip of extended thumb touches lips, then moves down to contact L. palm.
Also ***regional*** INSURANCE.



LIGHT (on), PUT LIGHT ON

Full 'O' hand springs down/open. Can be **located** to suit context, both hands for plural.



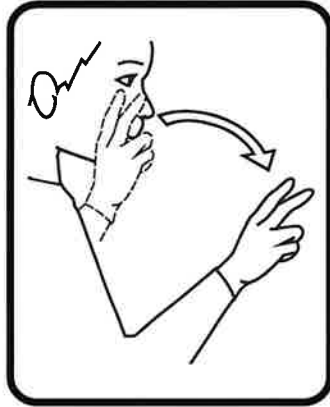
LIGHT (weight)

Palm up open hands make upward wafting movements.



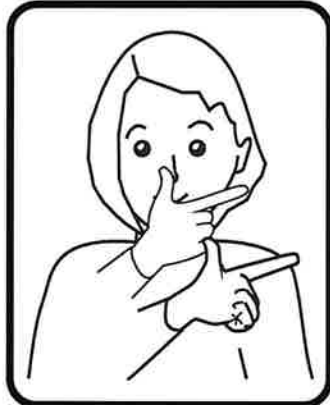
LOOK AFTER, SUPERVISE

R. 'V' hand on top of L. at an angle; hands move down from near eye.



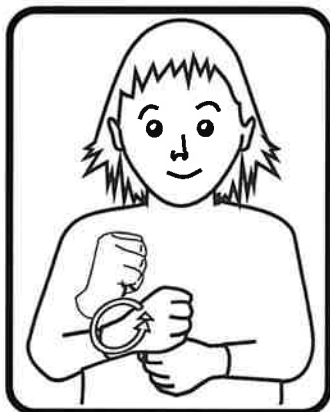
LOOK, LOOK AT, SEE

'V' hand (eye gaze classifier) makes short movement forward, or in **direction** to suit context.



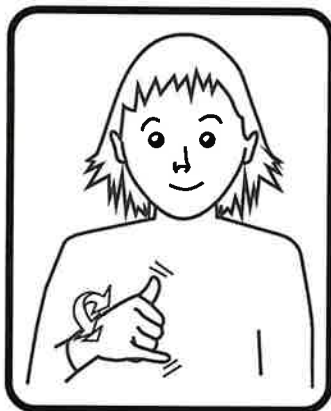
LUCKY, GOOD LUCK

Thumb tip of 'L' hand brushes down from nose as hand twists to palm down. **Varies.**



MAKE, DO, REPAIR, MEND

Edge of R. fist bangs top of L. fist in circular movements.



MAYBE, MIGHT, PERHAPS

'Y' hand waggles quickly from wrist, lips stretched.



MEET

Upright index fingers (person classifiers) held apart, move in towards each other. ***Directional.***



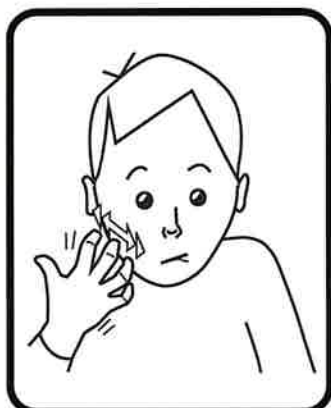
MEETING, CONFERENCE

Index fingers circle round each other.



MINICOM, TEXT PHONE

L. 'Y' hand held above palm down R. hand with wiggling fingers.



MISTAKE, ERROR, SORRY

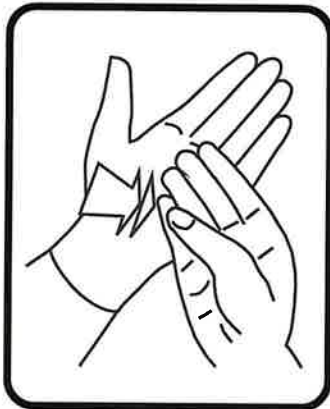
Clawed hand makes small shaking movements near chin or side of head.

Varies. Also means **ACCIDENT.**



MOBILE-PHONE

Hand with fingers tightly curled held at side of face.



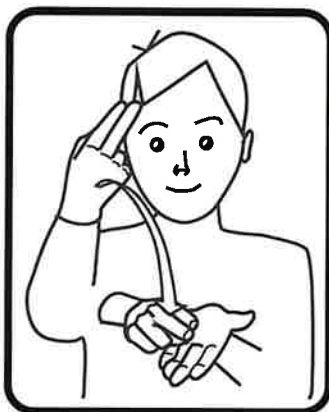
MONEY, CASH, FINANCE

Backs of fingers of R.
bunched hand tap L. palm
twice. ***Varies.***



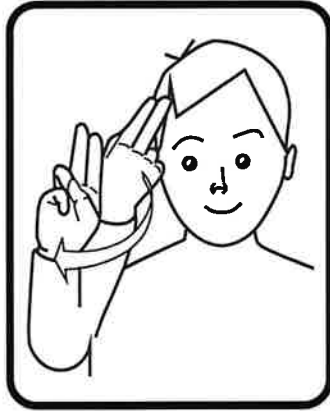
MORNING, GOOD MORNING

Fingertips of R. bent hand
(with thumb up) touch left
then right side of chest.
Varies.



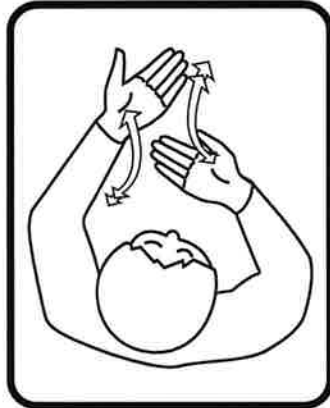
NAME DOWN, ENROL

Tips of 'N' hand on side of
forehead move down to
contact L. palm. Also
means **SIGN FOR.**



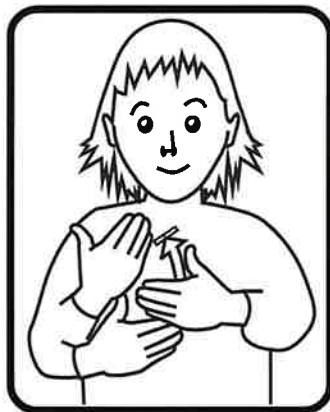
NAME, CALLED

Tips of 'N' hand touch side of forehead, then move and twist forward.



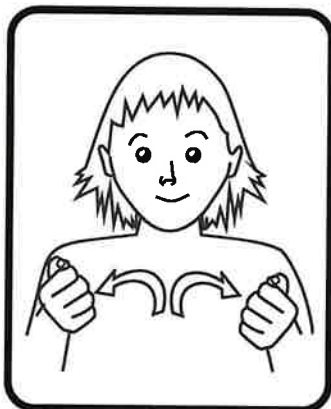
NEGOTIATE, CONSULT

Palm up flat hands move backwards and forwards several times. Also means **DEALINGS, TRADE.**



NEW, FRESH, LATEST

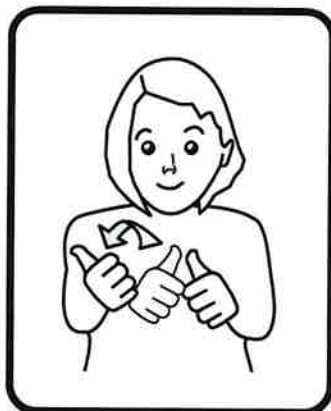
R. flat hand brushes sharply up behind L.



NEWSPAPER, MAGAZINE

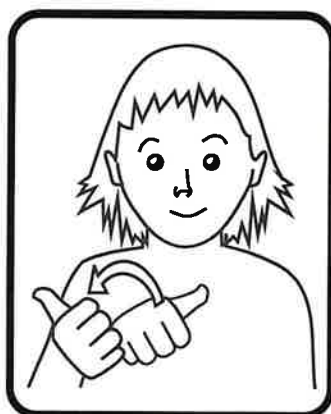
Hands twist over and apart in action of holding and opening a newspaper.

Also means **CATALOGUE**.



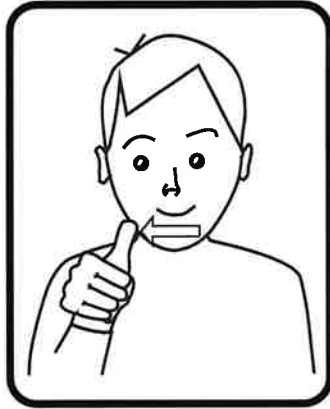
NEXT TO, BESIDE

Closed hands with thumbs extended; R. hand twists from the wrist to the right, away from L. hand



NEXT, AFTER, THEN, TURN

Extended thumb twists over from palm down to palm up. ***Directional***.



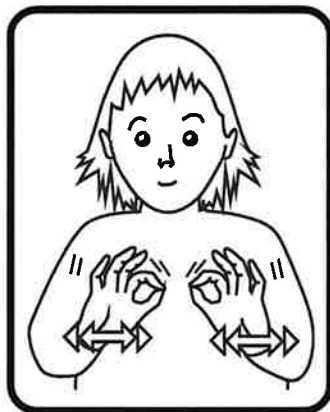
NICE, SWEET, APPETISING

R. thumb moves across chin from left to right.



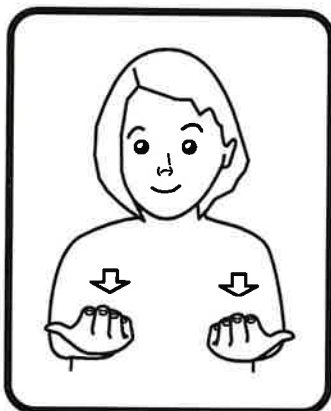
NOT YET, BEFORE, WAIT

Palm forward closed hands make short repeated movements in towards each other as head shakes with 'shh' lip-pattern.



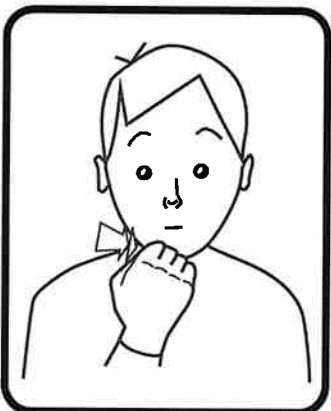
NOTHING, NONE, NOBODY

'O' hands (or full 'O' hands) shake from side to side, or make repeated circles towards each other. Tongue tip may protrude.



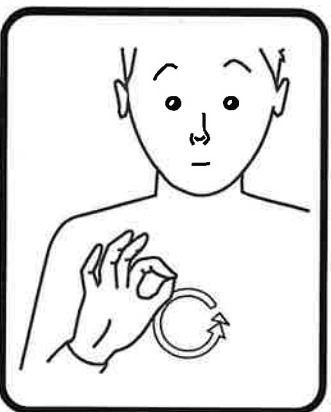
NOW

Palm up flat hands make single short movement down. Firm movement for **RIGHT NOW**.



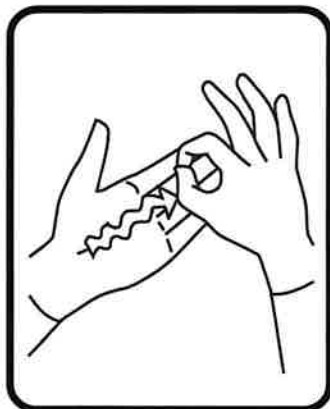
NUMBER, DATE, MATHS

Knuckles of closed hand tap chin twice. With raised eyebrows can also mean **HOW MANY?**



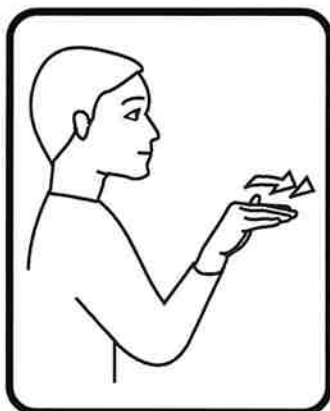
OFFICE

Palm forward 'O' hand moves round in small circles. ***Varies.***



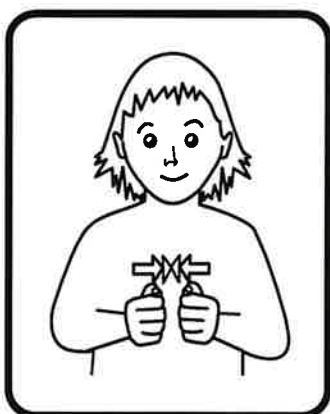
OFFICE, SECRETARY

'O' hand moves along L. palm with small squiggling movements. ***Varies.***



OUTSIDE, ABROAD

Bent hand makes two short forward movements. Also means **FOREIGN/ER.**



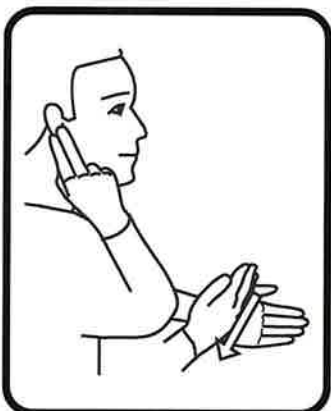
PAPER

Tap knuckles of both closed hands together twice. One of several ***variations.***



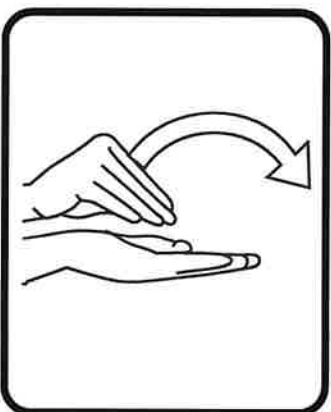
PARK, STATIONARY (car)

Edge of R. flat hand rests on L. palm; hands make short movement down.



PARTIALLY DEAF

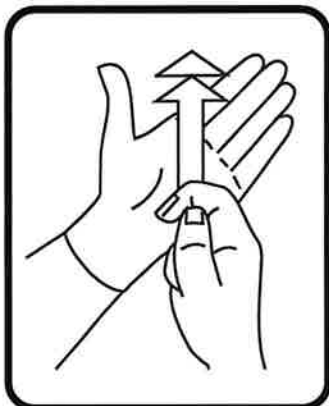
R. flat hand is drawn down across L. palm, then 'N' hand touches ear.



PAY, PAYMENT, PAY FOR

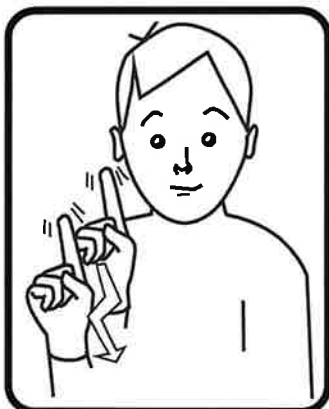
R. bunched hand (or Irish T hand) moves forward from L. palm in small arc.

Directional.



PAY, PAYMENTS, RENT

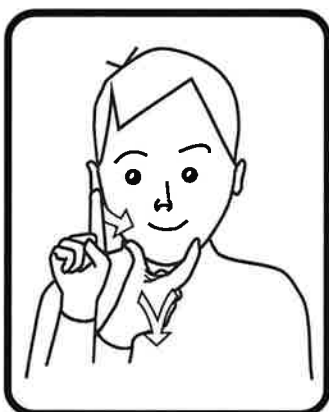
R. Irish 'T' hand moves forward from L. palm several times. Also means **MORTGAGE** and other regular payments.



PEOPLE

Palm forward index finger moves down in short zigzag or index finger, palm left with little finger up, taps chin twice.

Regional.



PEOPLE, HUMAN, PUBLIC

Index and thumb close together as they brush down chin, then index finger brushes forward on cheek.



PERSONAL PAGER

Fingers vibrate rapidly against thumb near waist. Vibrating Pagers are used by deaf people, to alert to baby, doorbell, fire, or other alarm systems.



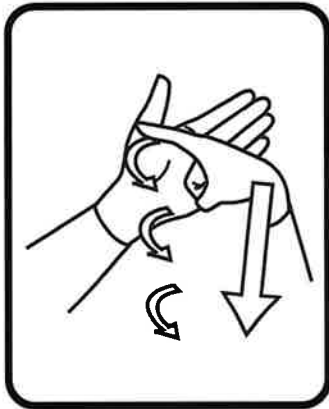
PLEASE, THANKS

Tips of flat hand touch mouth, then hand swings forward/down to finish palm up.



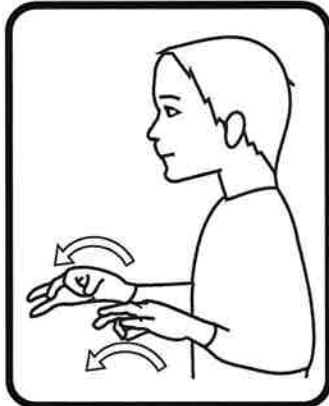
PLEASED, HAPPY, GLAD

Flat hand rubs in circles on chest with pleased expression.



POLICY, RULES

R. index moves down/back from L. palm, or down left arm in small hops. Also means **PRINCIPLES, REGULATIONS.**



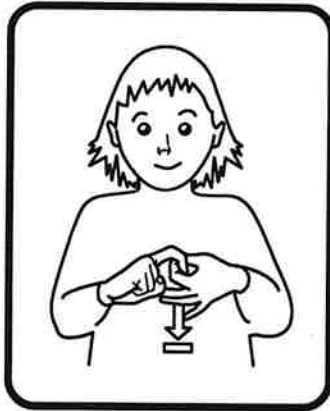
POSTPONE, DELAY

'O' hands move forward together in small arc. Also means, **PUT OFF.** The hands move back for **BRING FORWARD.**



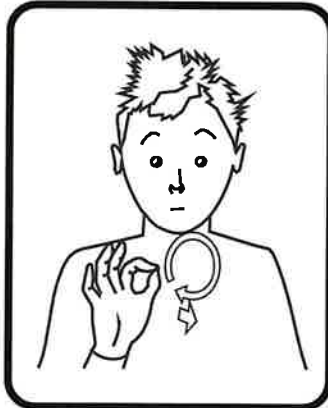
PRIVATE, SECRET

Index edge of flat hand taps twice against the lips. ***Varies.***



QUALIFICATION/S

Hands form fingerspelt 'Q' and make short movement down. Also means **QUALIFIED**, and **QUALITY**.



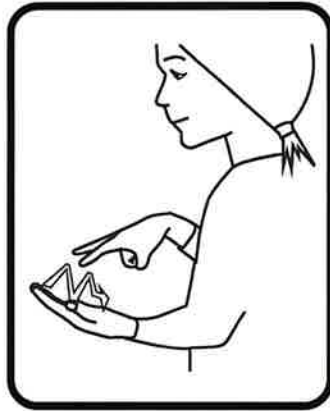
QUESTION, QUERY

Palm forward 'O' hand moves round in small circle, then makes short forward movement.



QUICK, FAST, HURRY

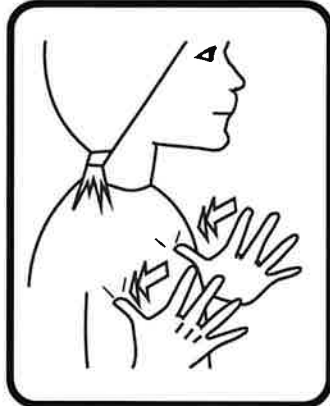
R. index taps on L. several times very quickly.



READ

R. 'V' hand (eye gaze classifier) sweeps from side to side above L. palm.

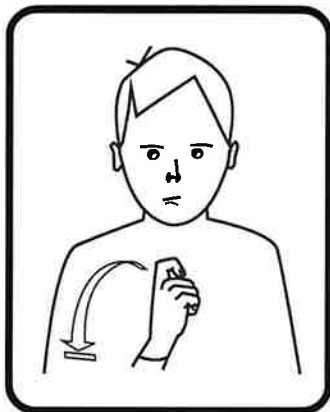
Direction and movement will suit context.



READY, PREPARED

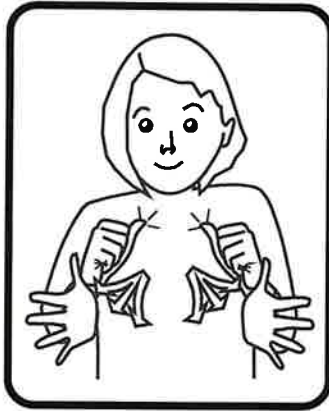
Thumbs of open hands (or just one hand) tap upper chest twice, or make upward brushing movements. Also means

GET READY.



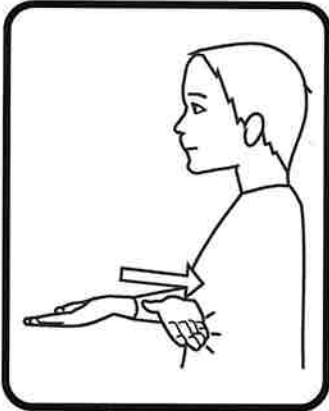
REDUNDANT, LAY OFF

Irish 'T' hand moves forward/down or in ***direction*** relevant to context.



RETIRE, RETIREMENT

Thumb tips of closed hands contact chest, then hands spring forward/open.



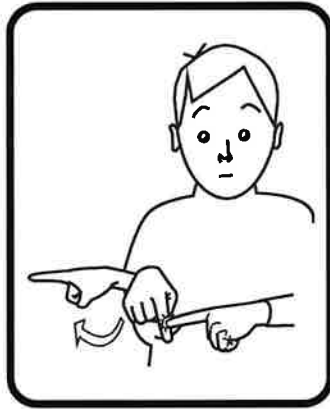
RIGHT, RIGHTS

Palm up flat hand moves back to touch lower chest. Used as in *'it's your right'* *'what are my rights?'*



RISK/Y, APPREHENSIVE

Tips of 'O' hand tap into neck twice, lips stretched with teeth clenched.



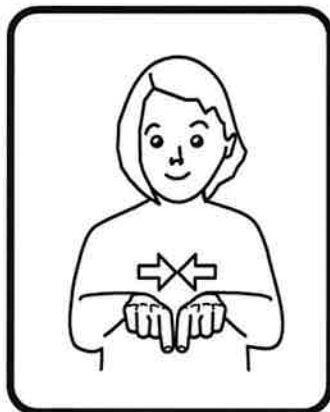
SACK, DISMISS, FIRE

R. index fingers twists sharply forward from wrist, brushing against tip of L. index finger. ***Directional.***



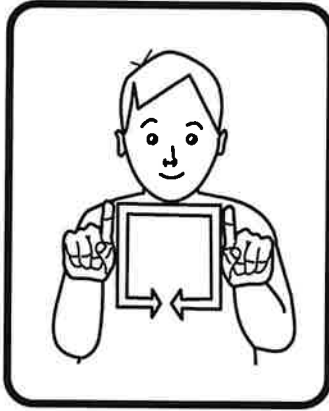
SAFE, SAFETY, SECURE

R. bent hand on L. palm as hands move back to body.



SAME, SIMILAR, LIKE

Index fingers pointing forward contact each other. May tap twice or make single contact. Also means **ALSO, TOO.**



SCREEN, MONITOR, TV

Index fingers move out, down and inwards in outline shape of screen.



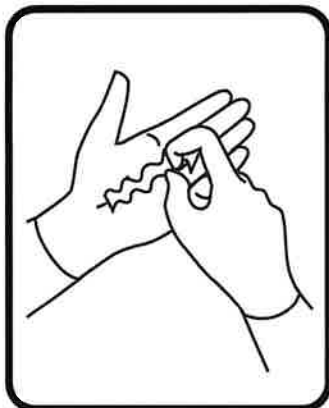
SEE YOU LATER

R. 'V' hand (or index finger) moves forward from eye, then index moves to the right in small arc.



SERVICE/S, PROVIDE

Palm up flat hands move together from the right to the front of body. Also means **PROVISION**.



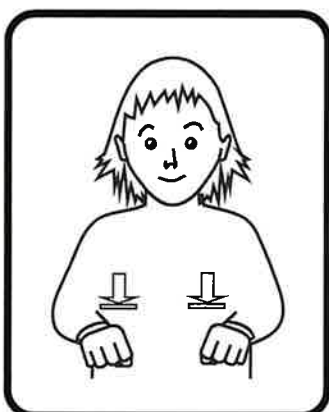
SIGN ON

'R' hand moves in writing action on L. palm. Also means to **SIGN, SIGNATURE.**



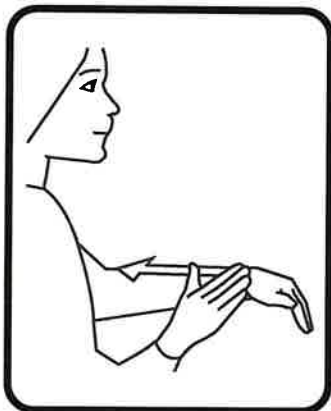
SIGN, SIGNING

Open hands move up and down alternately, or in alternate forward circles.



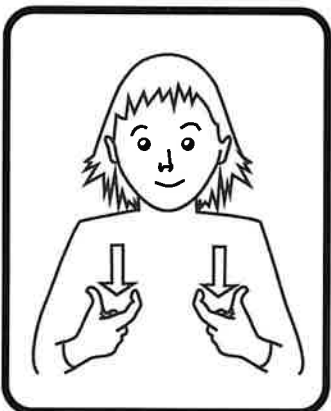
SIT DOWN, CHAIR, SEAT

Palm down closed hands make short firm movement down.



SLOW, SLOWLY, AGES

R. hand brushes from left wrist up the forearm. Also means **LONG TIME**.



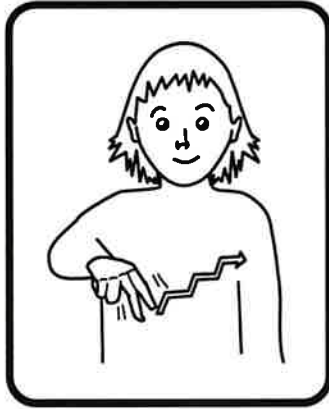
SOCIAL WORKER

Fingertips of 'C' hands move down sides of chest. May repeat. 'SW' or 'S worker' also sometimes used.



SORRY, REGRET

Closed hand rubs in circular movements on the chest with sorrowful expression. Little finger may be extended. **Varies.**



STAIRS, GO UPSTAIRS

Fingers of 'V' hand wiggle in diagonal upwards movement.



START, BEGIN, COMMENCE

R. closed hand with thumb up moves sharply down behind L. flat hand.

Varies.



STAY, REMAIN, BE STILL

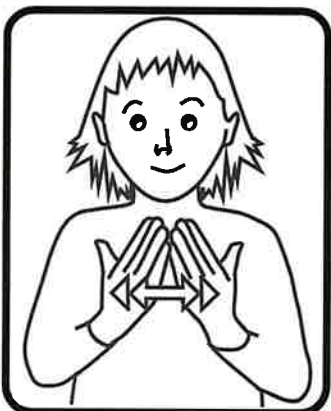
Palm down 'C' hands (or one hand) make short firm movement down or in ***direction*** of referent.



STOP, WAIT, HOLD ON

Palm forward flat hand (or both hands) makes a short firm forward movement.

Repeats for **WAIT, HOLD ON** etc. ***Varies.***



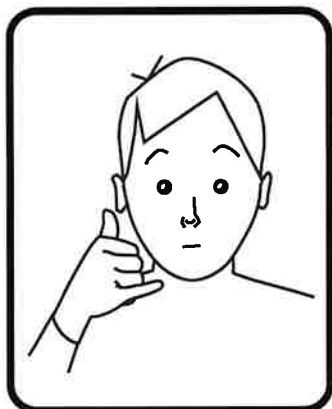
STUDY, READ

Palm back flat hands move together side to side several times.



TEA, CAFE, CUP OF TEA

'O' hand moves up and tips slightly back to the mouth.



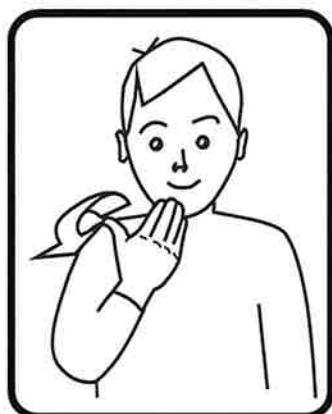
TELEPHONE, CALL

'Y' hand held near ear.
May move forward eg '*I'll phone*' or onto chest eg '*call me*' (***directional***). See also **MOBILE PHONE**.



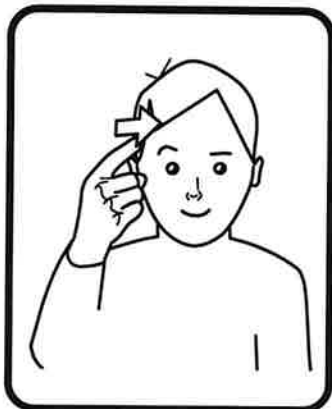
TEXT MESSAGE, SMS

Thumb flexes repeatedly
as hand moves in small
circles.



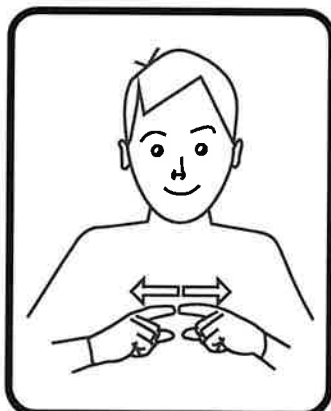
THANK YOU, APPRECIATE

Tips of flat hand touch
mouth, then hand swings
forward/down to finish
palm up. Both hands can
be used.



THINK

Index finger contacts side of forehead. May tap twice or make circular movements.



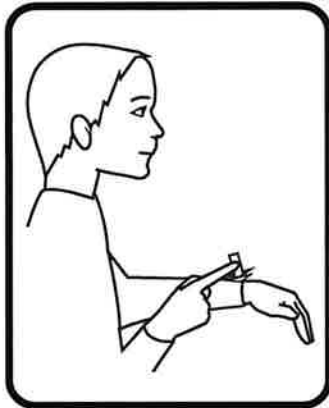
TICKET, CARD, PASS

Index fingers and thumbs extended and touching, move apart in outline shape. Also **RECEIPT, SLIP**. *Varies.*



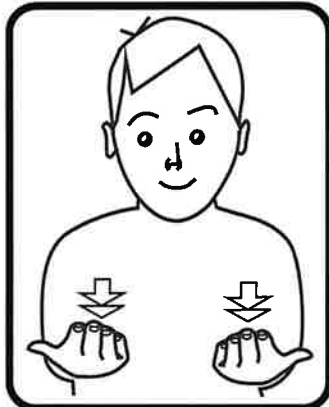
TIME TO GO

R. index finger taps back of L. wrist (**TIME**), then swings to point forward (**GO**).



TIME, WHAT TIME?

R. index taps back of left wrist twice. With brows raised or furrowed means **WHAT TIME?**



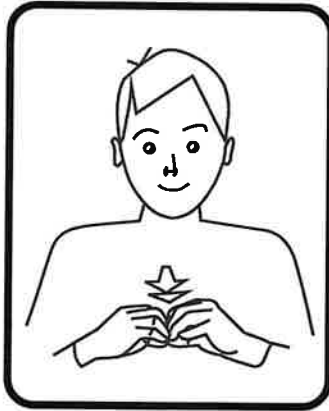
TODAY, AT THE MOMENT

Palm up flat hands make two short movements down. Single firm movement for **AT ONCE.**



TOMORROW, NEXT DAY

Index finger on side of cheek twists forward/down from the wrist to finish palm up. With 'V' hand means **IN TWO DAYS.**



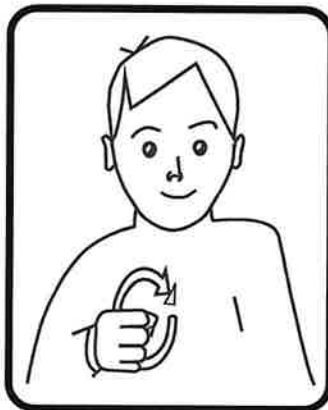
TRAIN, LEARN, STUDY

Tips of bunched hands together as hands move forward/down twice. Also means **STUDENT, TRAINEE**. *Varies.*



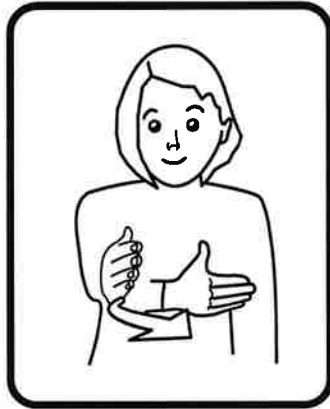
TRAIN, LEARN, STUDY

Palm down R. flat hand brushes forward against L. twice. Also means **STUDENT, TRAINEE**. *Varies.*



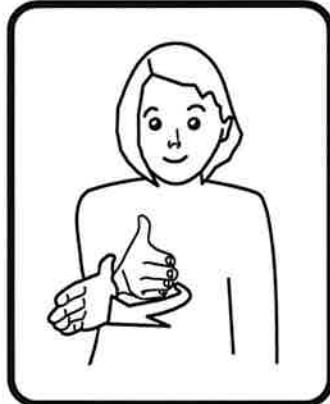
TRAIN, RAILWAY

Closed hand (or fist) makes forward circular motions at side of body, or single firm movement forward.



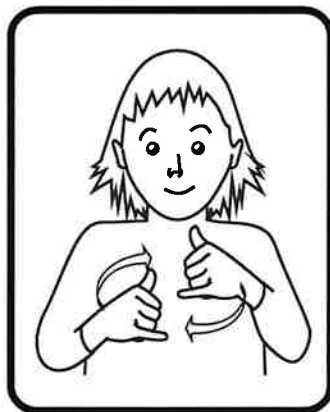
TURN LEFT

R. hand pointing forward
swings to the left.



TURN RIGHT

R. hand pointing forward
swings to the right.



TYPETALK, RELAY CALL

'Y' hands swap round to
change places.



UNDERGROUND, TUBE

R. extended index finger moves forward under palm down L. flat hand.



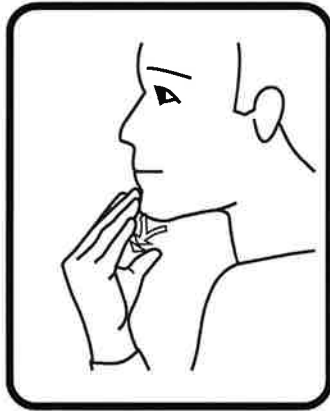
UNEMPLOYED, NO WORK

R. flat hand chops down onto L. at right angles, then hands move apart, palm up with headshake. Also means **OUT OF WORK**.



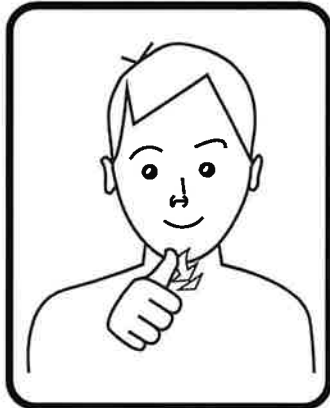
UNION, STEWARD

Tips of bent 'V' hand and thumb tap left upper chest twice, or make small twisting movement. Also means **BADGE, BROOCH**.



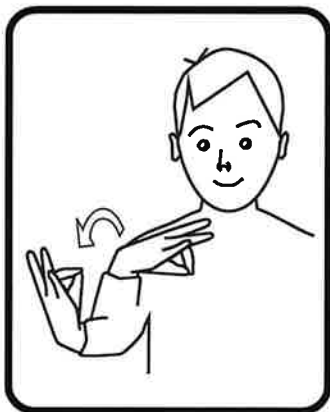
USE, USEFUL

Fingers of bent hand and thumb on chin close to bunched hand twice. Also one version of **TEMPORARY. *Varies.***



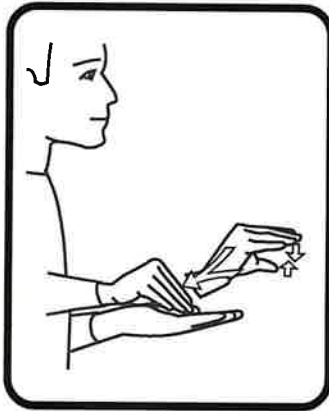
USE, USEFUL

Side of thumb brushes down twice off chin. Also ***regional* MAN.**



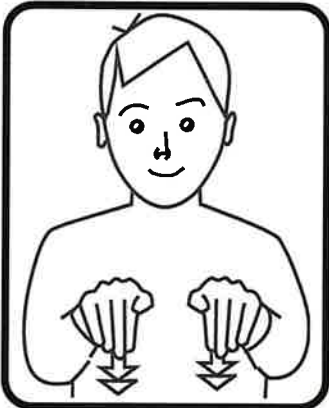
VOLUNTEER, INVITE/D

Tips of 'O' hand contact upper chest, then hand twists over and forwards, or tugs forward. Also means **BE CHOSEN, INVITATION.**



WAGE/S, PAY, SALARY

Fingers and thumb of R. bent hand close together as hand moves back down onto L. palm. R. clawed hand can be used.



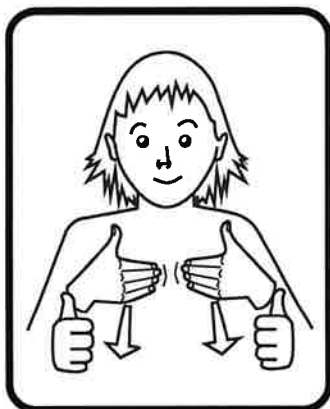
WAIT

Palm down bent hands (or closed hands) make two short downward movements.



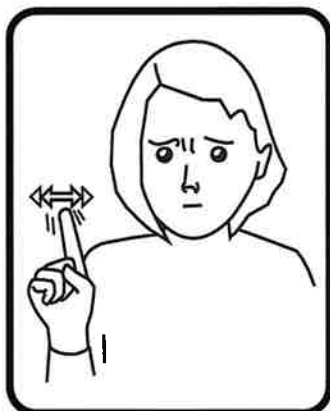
WANT, NEED

Flat hand brushes down side of chest twisting to palm down.



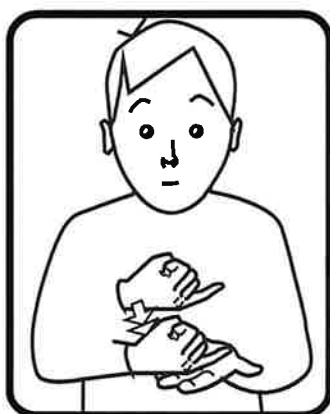
WELL, FINE, HEALTH

Bent hands touch chest then move forward closing with thumbs up. With raised brows means **ARE YOU WELL?**



WHAT? WHAT FOR?

Palm forward index makes small side to side shaking movements, eyebrows raised or furrowed. Also *regional* **WHY?**



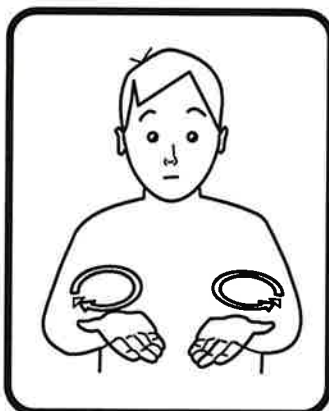
WHAT'S WRONG?

Extended little finger taps L. palm twice, eyebrows raised or furrowed. Also means **WHAT'S THE MATTER?**



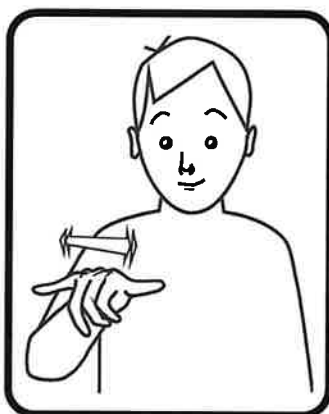
WHEN?

Fingers wiggle at side of face, eyebrows raised or furrowed.



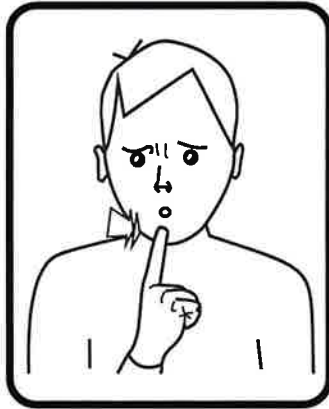
WHERE? WHEREABOUTS

Palm up hands move in small outward circles, or hands may move in-out towards each other, eyebrows raised or furrowed.



WHICH?

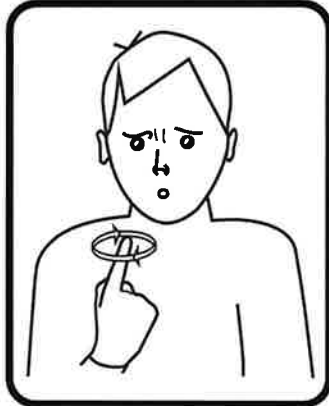
'Y' hand moves from side to side or between the objects or persons referred to, eyebrows raised or furrowed.



WHO?

Palm left R. index fingertip taps chin twice, eyebrows raised or furrowed.

Varies.



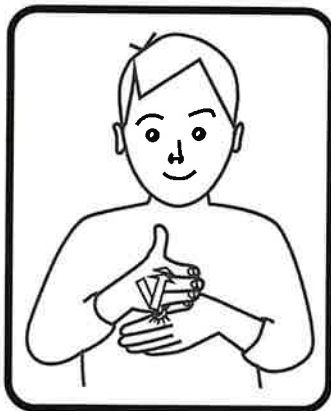
WHO?

Index finger makes small horizontal circles, eyebrows raised or furrowed. ***Varies.***



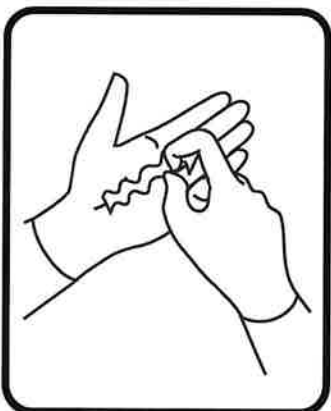
WHY?

Edge of R. index taps side of left upper chest twice, eyebrows raised or furrowed. Can also mean **BECAUSE** with neutral expression.



WORK, CAREER, JOB

Edge of R. flat hands makes short forward tapping movements on L. at right angles. Also means **EMPLOYMENT**.



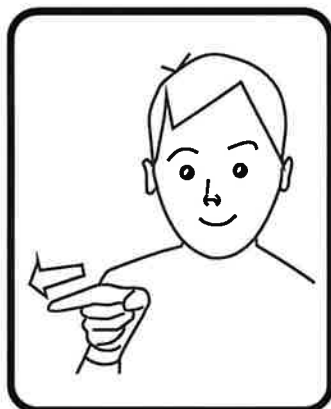
WRITE, PEN AND PAPER

R. 'O' hand moves along L. palm with squiggling movements. Also means **SIGN FOR, SIGN ON, TAKE NOTES**.



YESTERDAY, DAY BEFORE

Index finger on side of cheek twists back/down onto shoulder. With 'V' hand means **TWO DAYS AGO**.



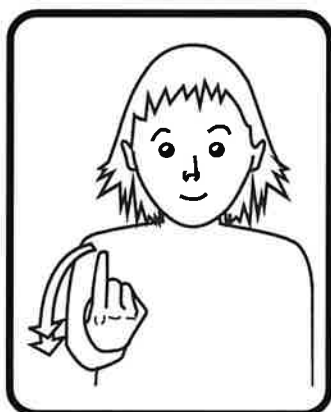
YOU

Index points with short movement towards referent (with eye gaze). Sideways sweep for plural. ***Directional.***



YOUR, YOURS

Palm forward closed hand is directed towards referent (with eye gaze). Sideways sweep for plurals. ***Directional.***



YOURSELF, HIM/HERSELF

Palm back index held forward makes short movements down/forward in ***direction*** of referent.

USEFUL CONTACTS

(V) indicates a voice line and (T) a text line

British Association of Teachers of the Deaf (BATOD)

Paul Simpson, Secretary
175 Dashwood Avenue, High Wycombe,
Buckinghamshire HP12 3DB.

Answerphone/Fax: 01494 464190

e-mail: secretary@batod.org.uk

web: www.batod.org.uk

British Deaf Association (BDA)

Coventry Point, Market Way, Coventry CV1 1EA.

Tel/Voice: 02476 550936

Tel/Text: 02476 550393 **Fax:** 02476 221541

IP: 84.12.97.143

e-mail: midlands@signcommunity.org.uk

web: www.signcommunity.org.uk

CACDP

Durham University Science Park,
Block 4, Stockton Road, Durham DH1 3UZ.

Tel: 0191 383 1155 (V/T)

Text: 0191 383 7915 **Fax:** 0191 383 7914

e-mail: durham@cacdp.org.uk

web: www.cacdp.org.uk